8-paths-cycles: 路径与圈 (Paths and Cycles)

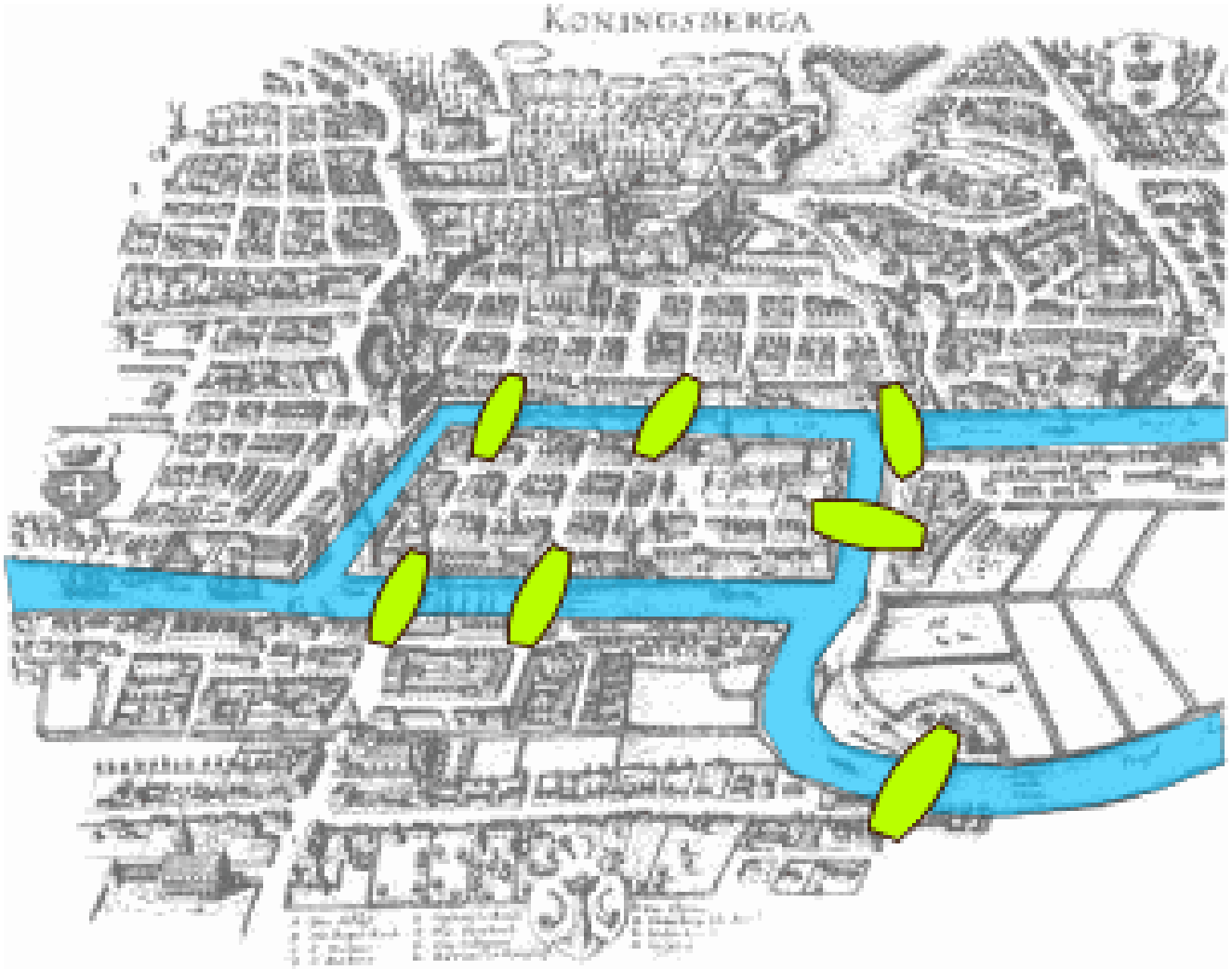
魏恒峰

hfwei@hnu.edu.cn

2026 年 04 月 22 日

Definitions Theorems Proofs

Seven Bridges of Königsberg (柯尼斯堡七桥问题)



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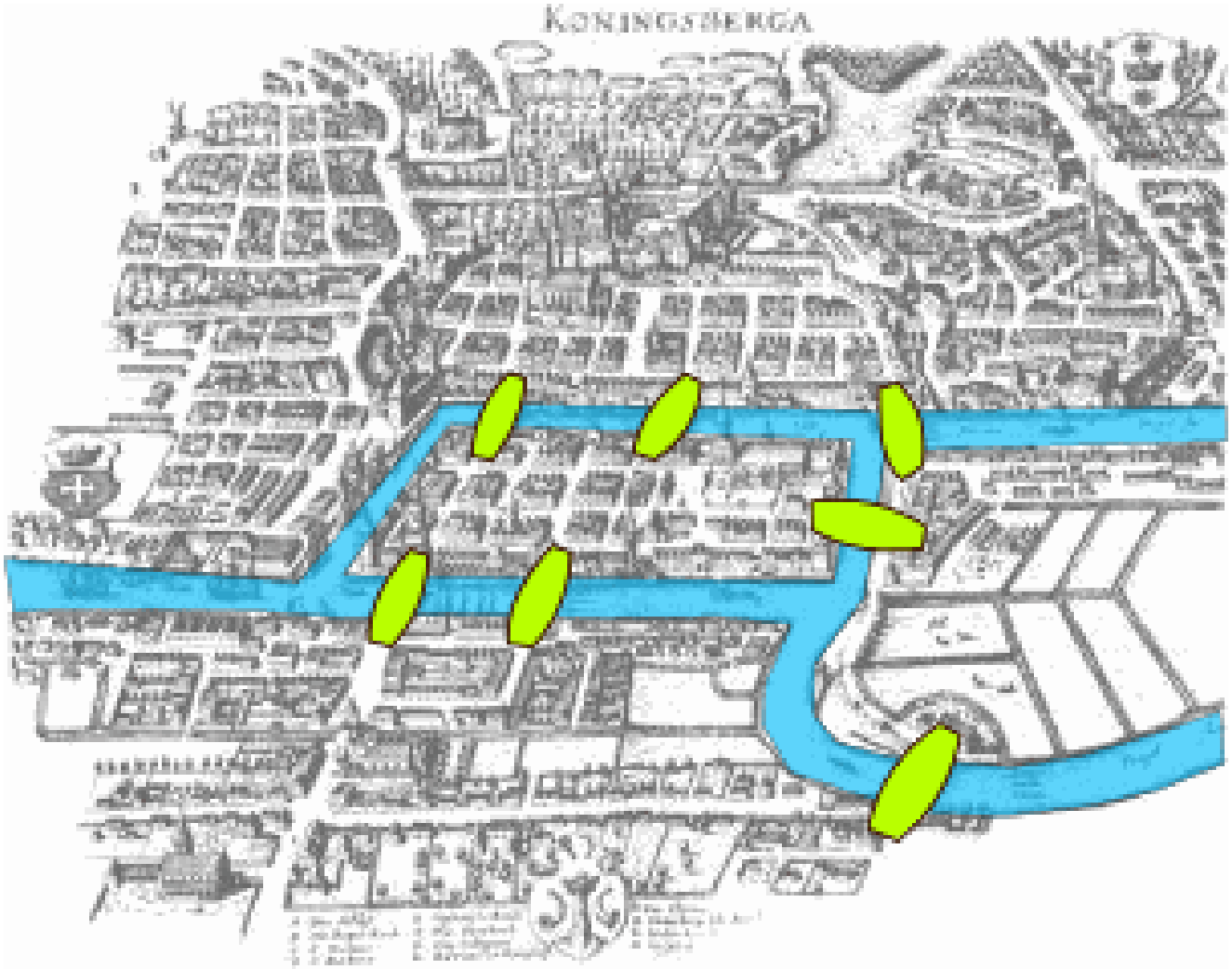

"to devise a walk through the city
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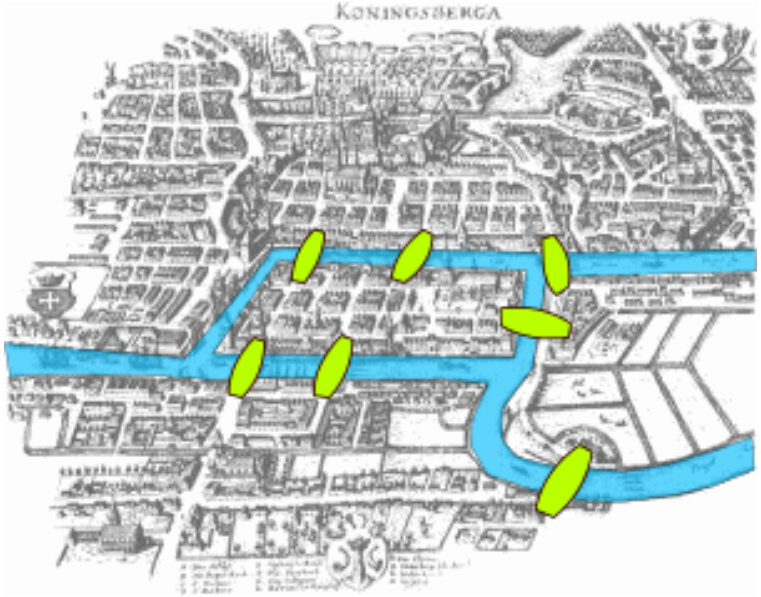
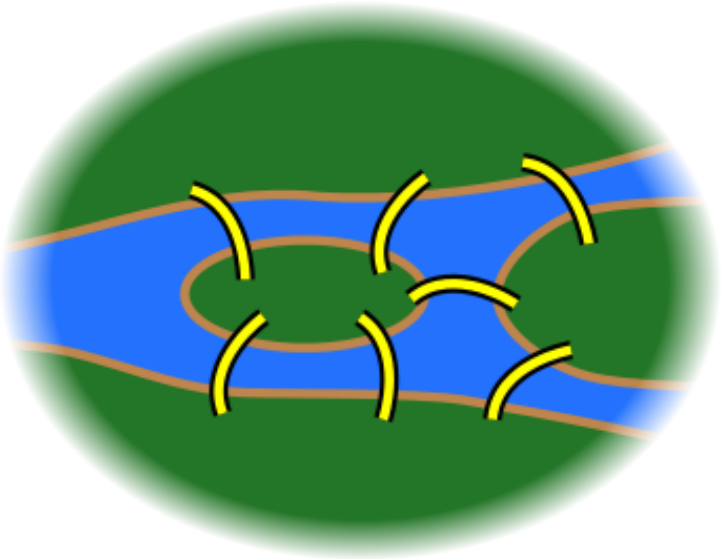
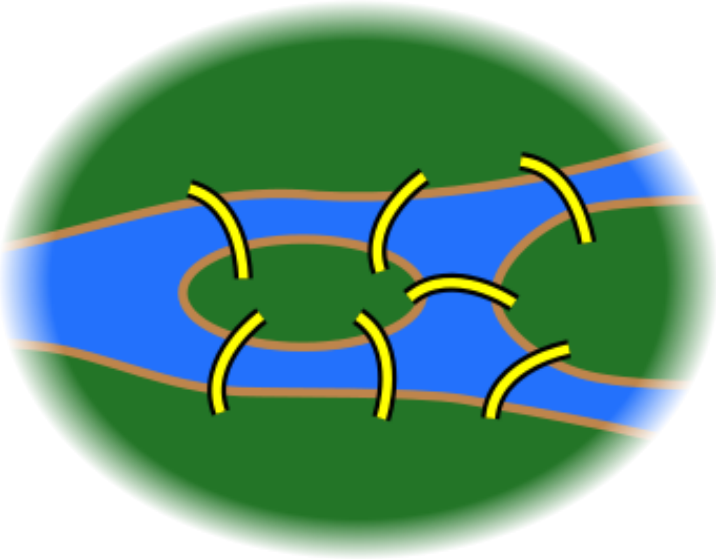
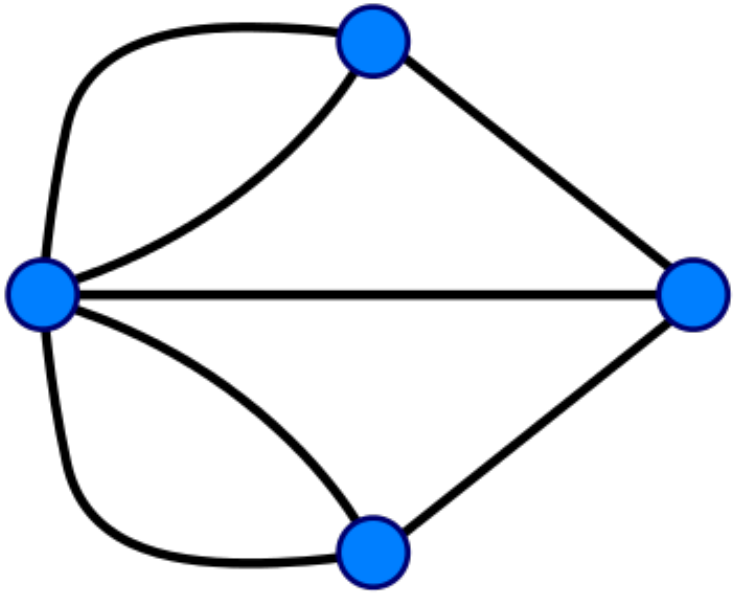
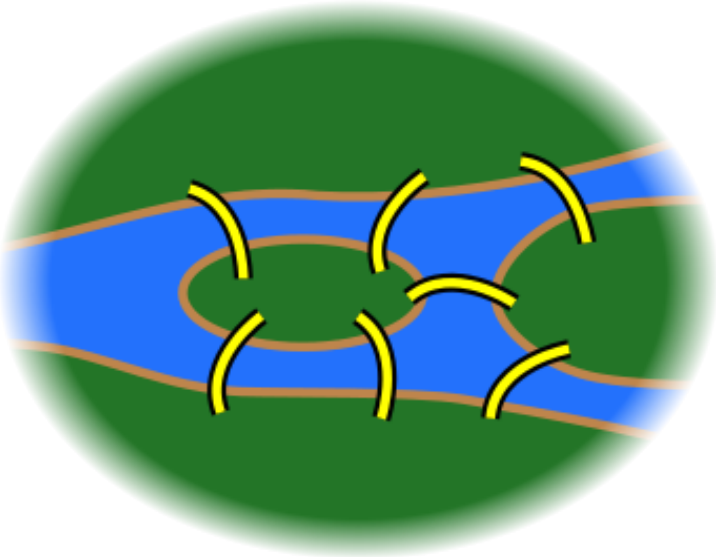
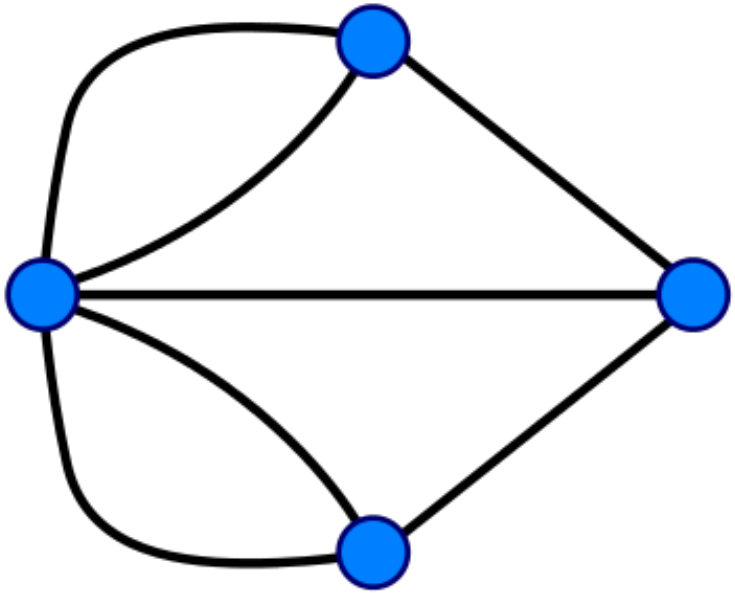

KONINGSBERGA









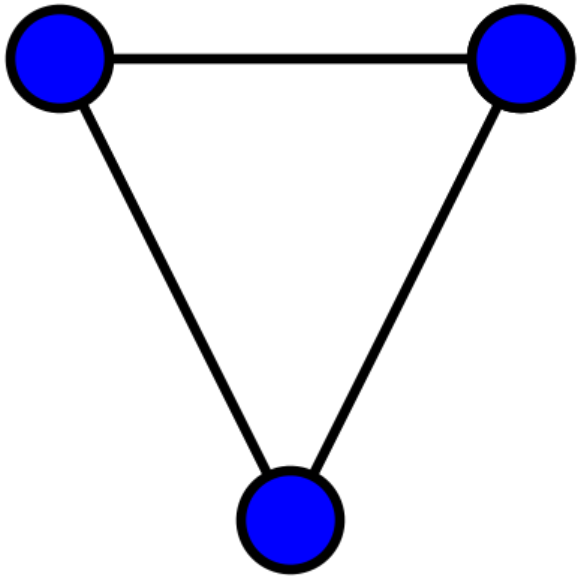


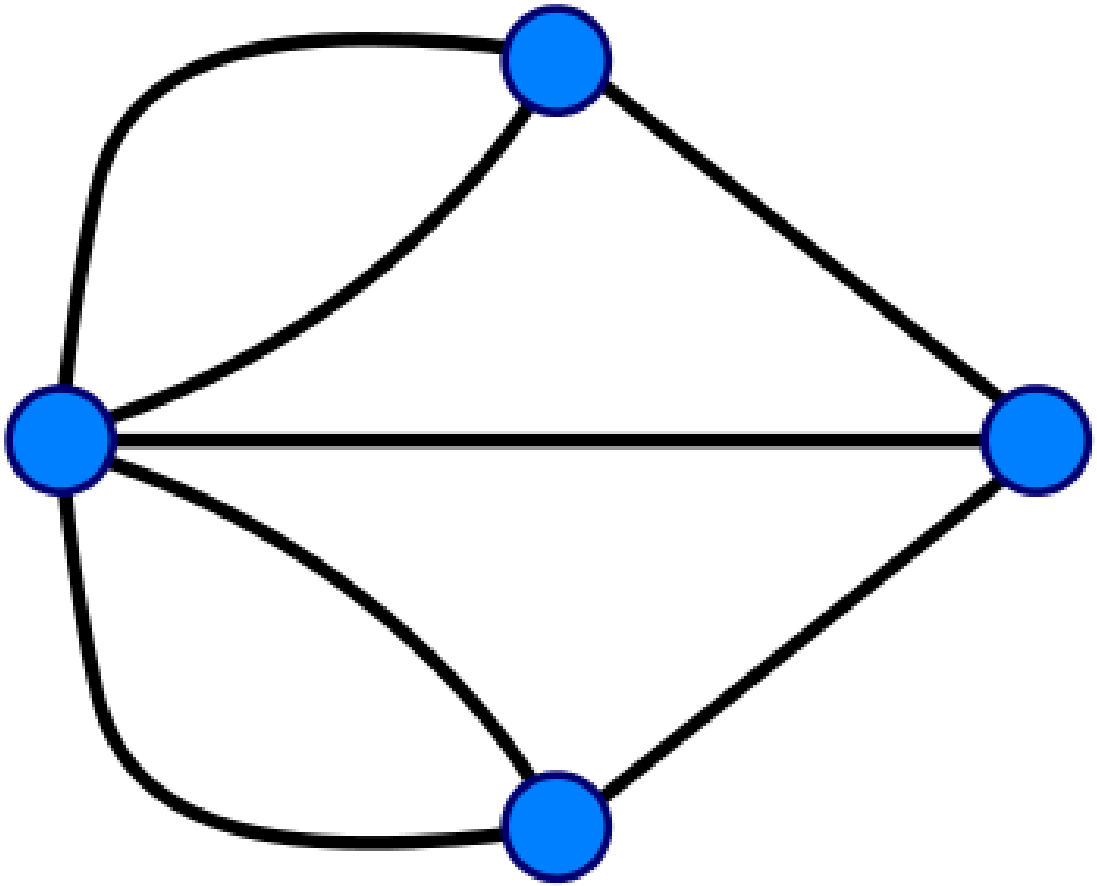
"to devise a walk through the graph
that would cross each of those edges once and only once"

Definition (Graph (图))

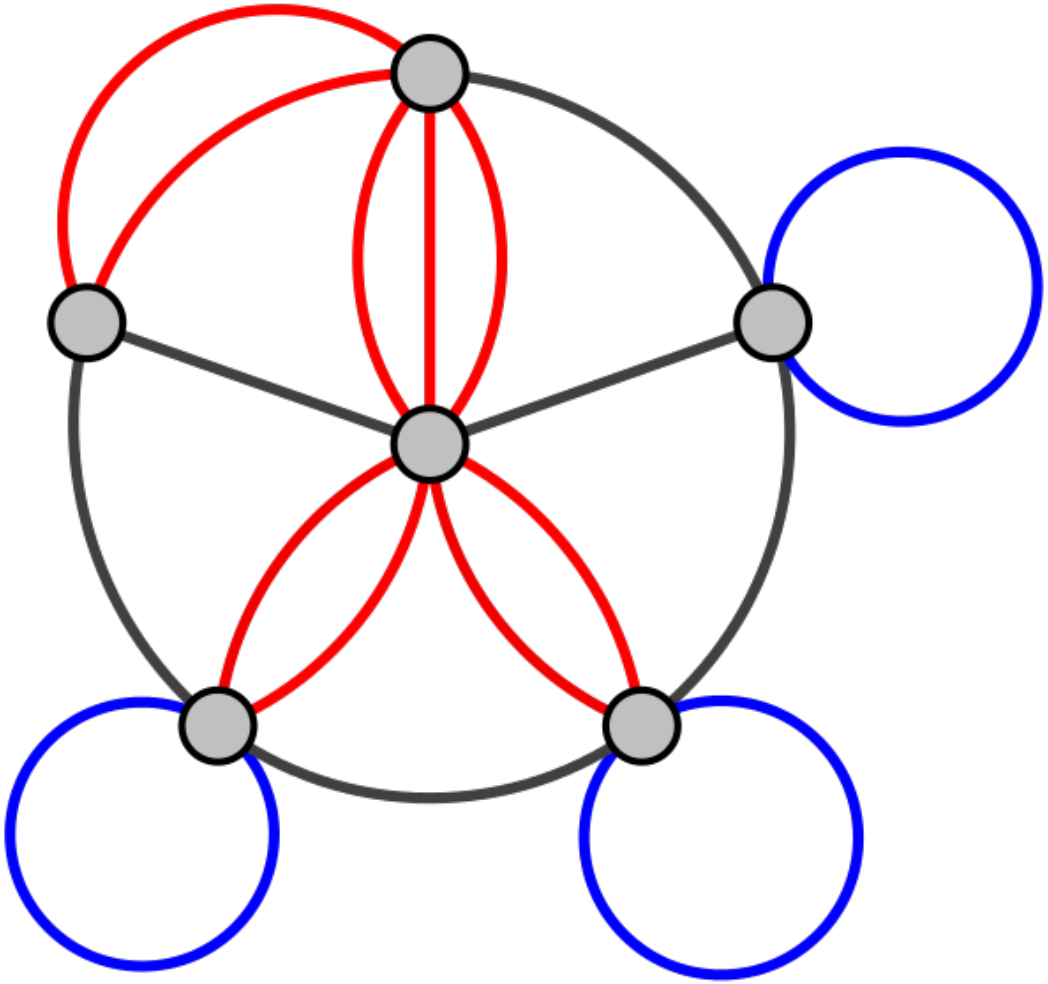
An (undirected simple) graph is a pair $G = (V, E)$ where

- V is a set of vertices (顶点);
- $E \subseteq \{\{x, y\} \mid x, y \in V \wedge x \neq y\}$ is a set of edges





Undirected Multigraph



Undirected Multigraph Permitting Loops

Definition (Walk (道路))

Given a graph G, a (finite) walk in G is a sequence of edges of the form

$$\{v_0, v_1\}, \{v_1, v_2\}, \ldots, \{v_{m-1}, v_m\}.$$

$$(v_0 \to v_1 \to v_2 \to \cdots \to v_m)$$

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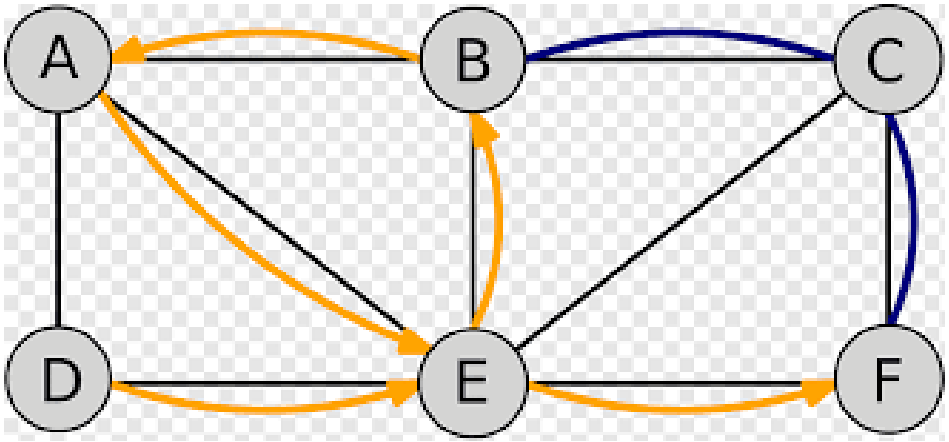

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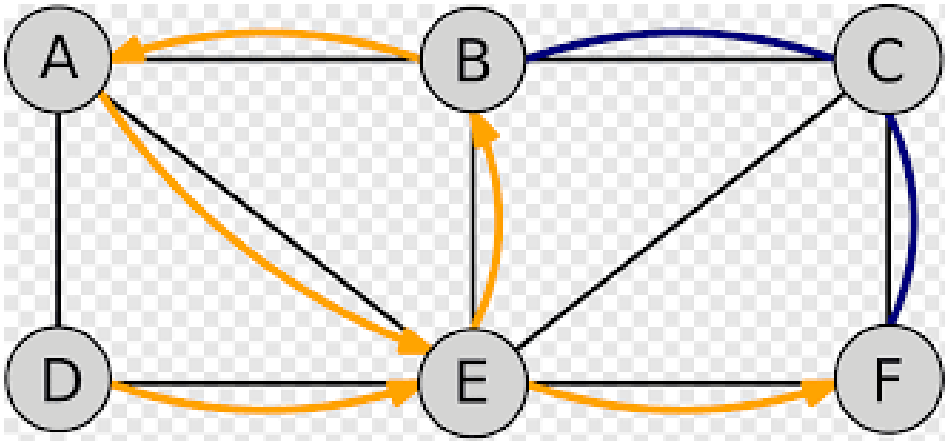

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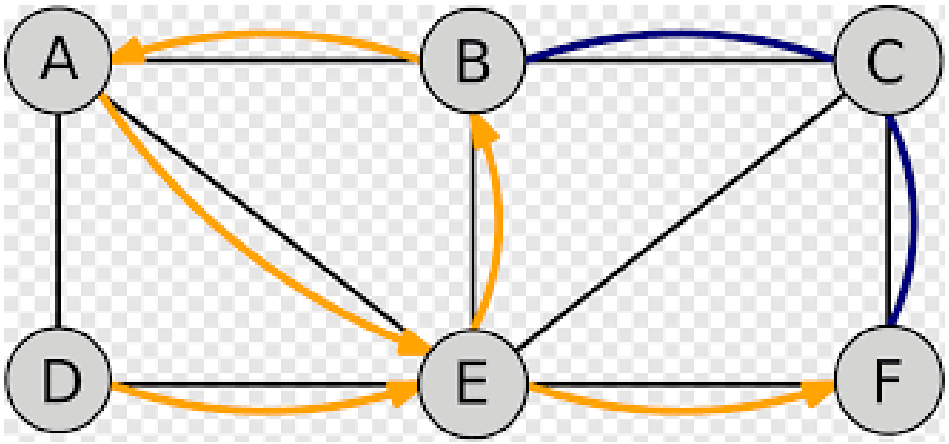

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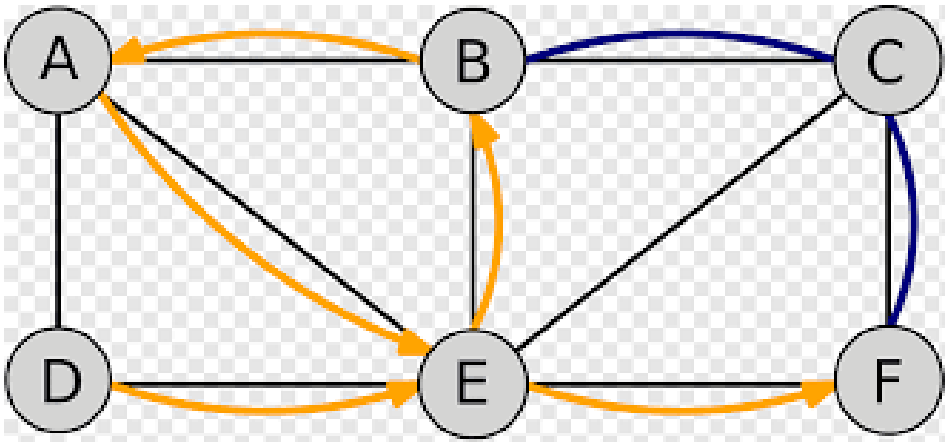

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A walk, trail, or path is closed if $v_0 = v_m$.

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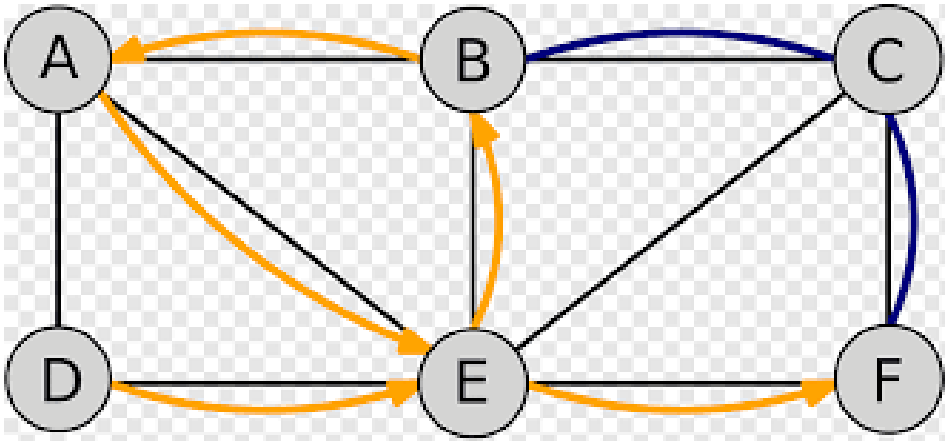

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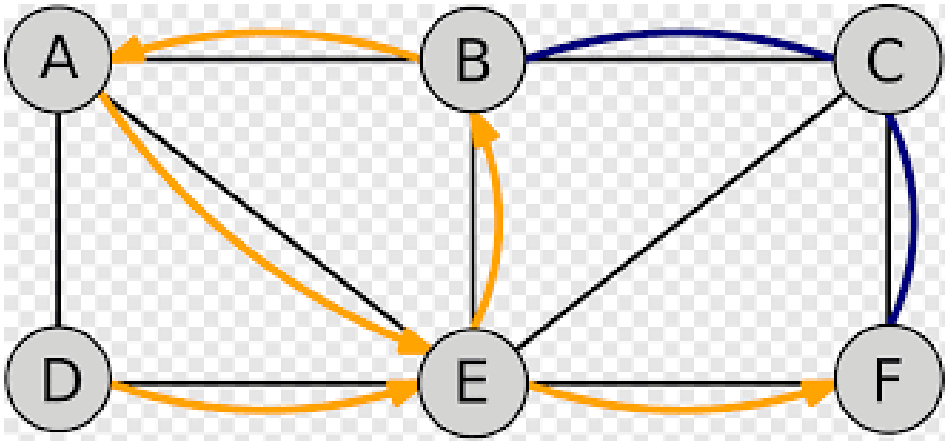

Definition (Cycle)

A cycle is a closed path with at least one edge.

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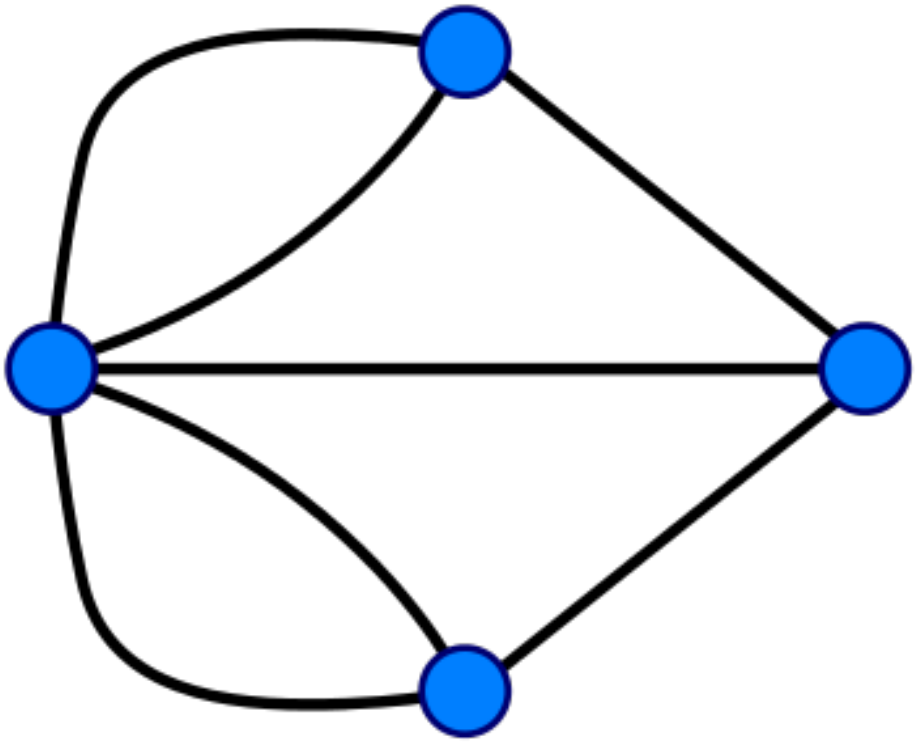

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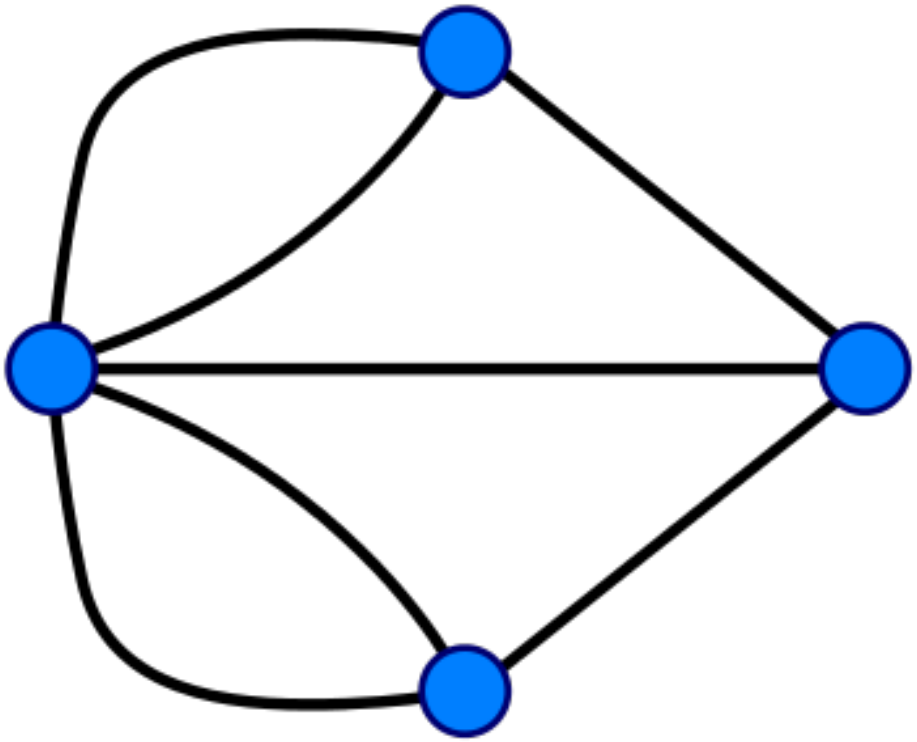
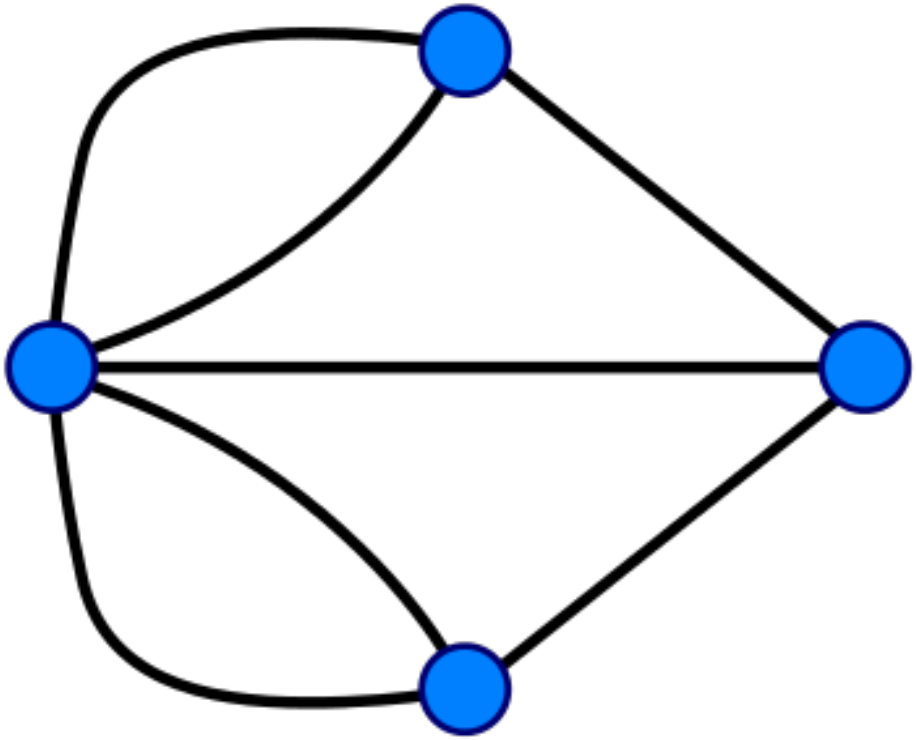


to find a trail that contains all edges of the graph

$$v_0 \to v_1 \to \cdots \to v_i \to \cdots \to v_m$$



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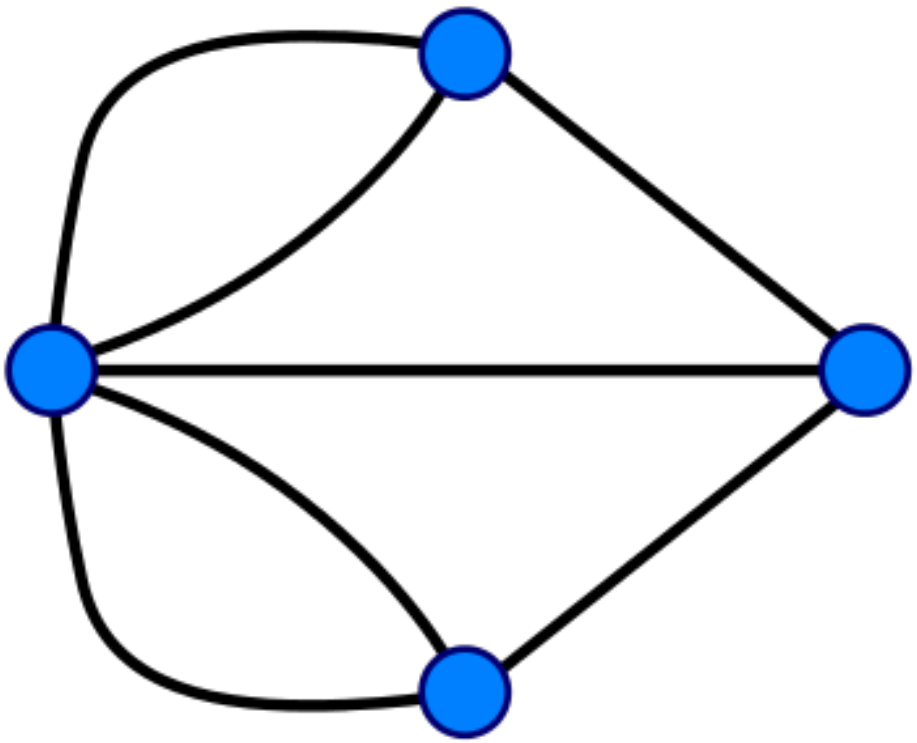

$$v_i \notin \{v_0, v_m\} \implies \deg(v_i) \text{ is even}$$

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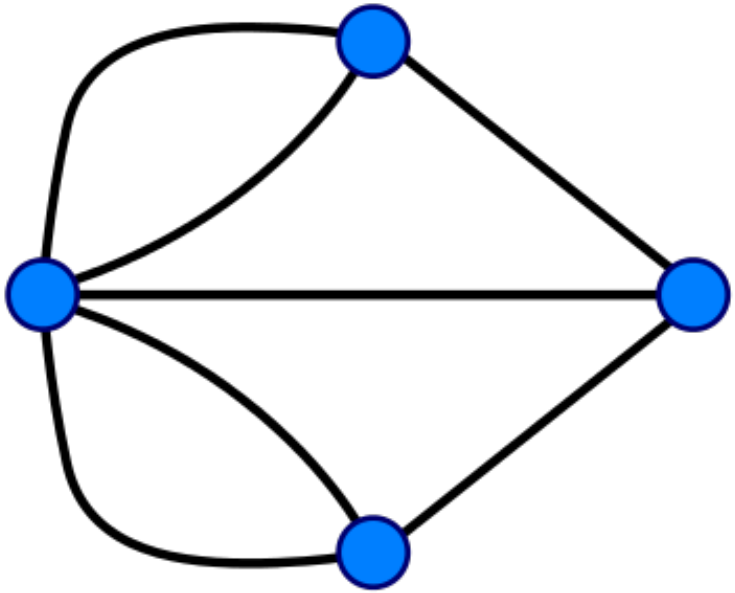

4 vertices of odd degree $\Longrightarrow$ has no Eulerian trails

Theorem (Euler's Theorem)

A connected graph has Eulerian trails iff it contains zero or two vertices that have an odd degree.

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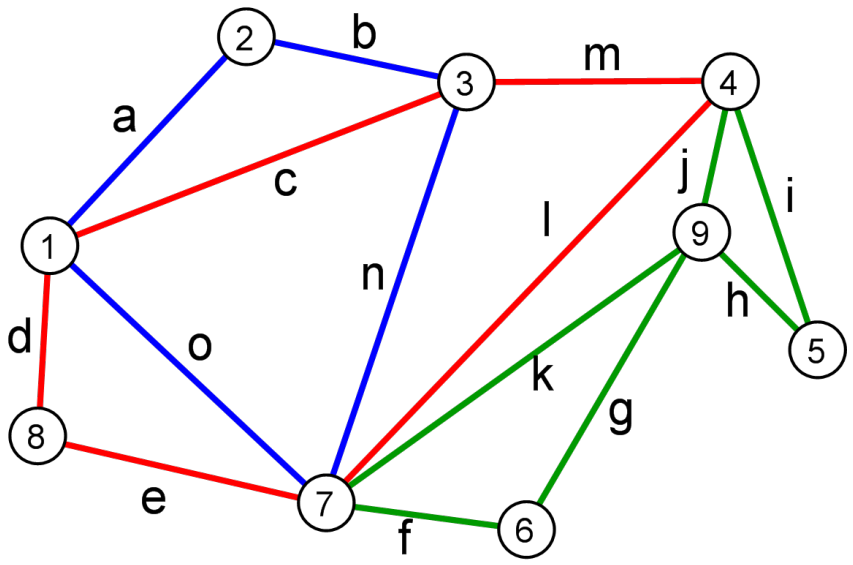

cycle + cycle + cycle

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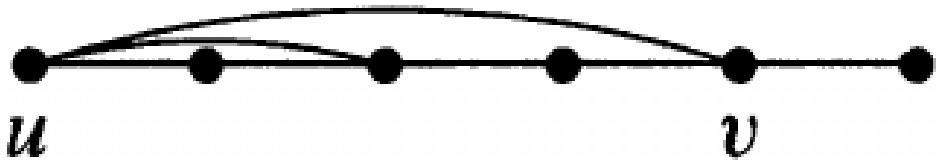

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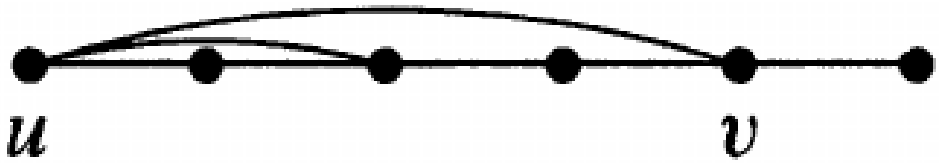

$\deg(u) \geq 2$

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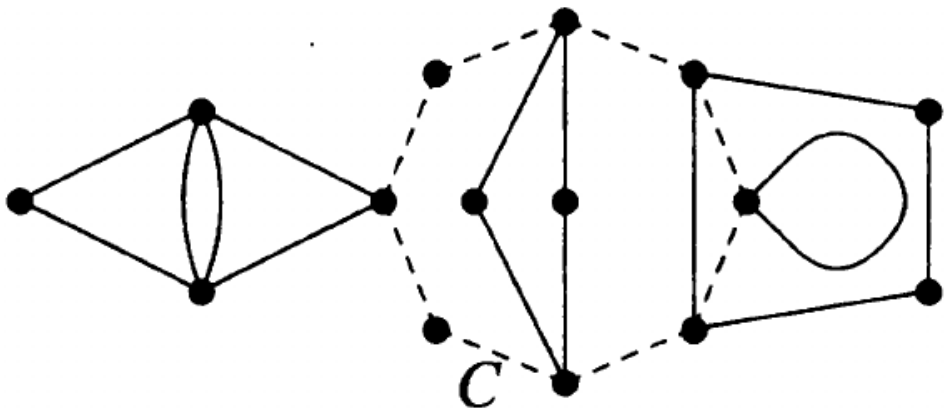
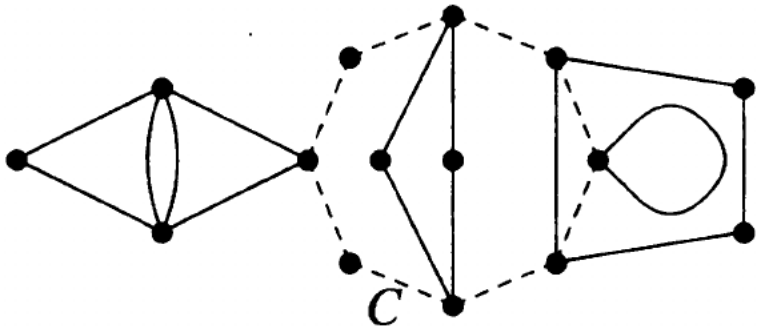
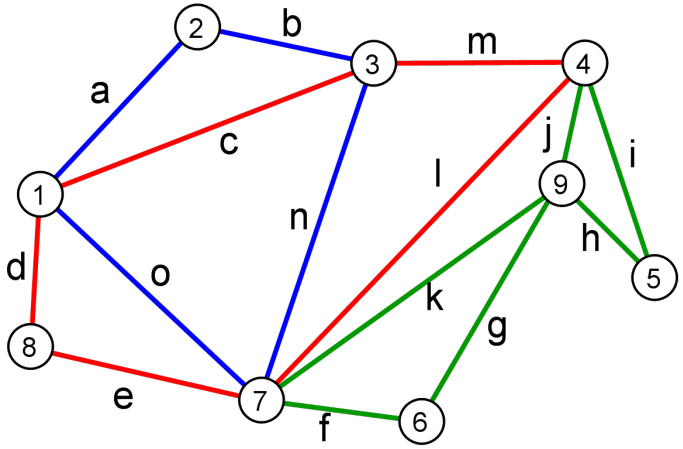


$$G' = G - C$$

Theorem

Every Eulerian graph decomposes into cycles.





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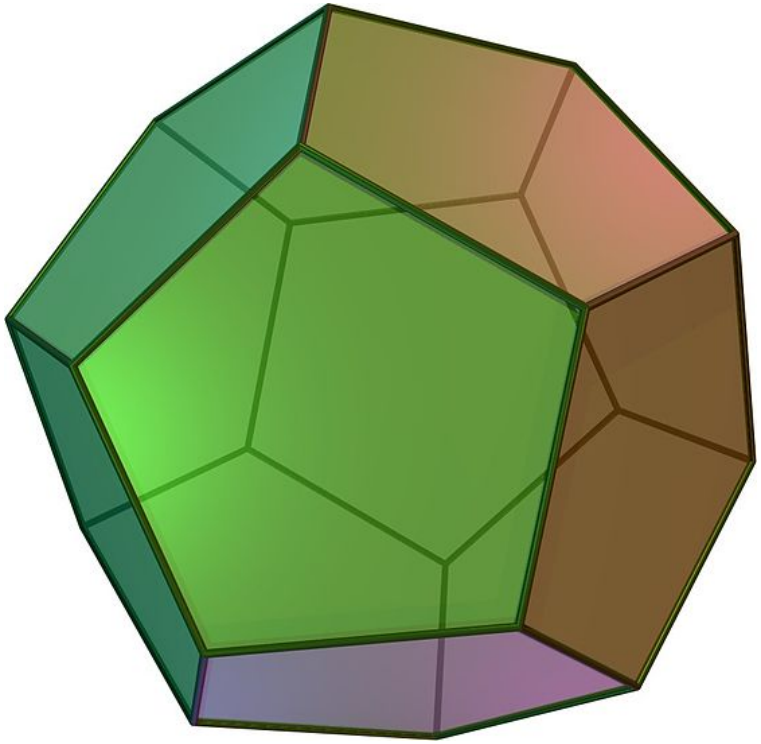
TONCAS

"The Obvious Necessary Conditions are Also Sufficient"

Dodecahedron: 12 faces, 20 vertices, and 30 edges



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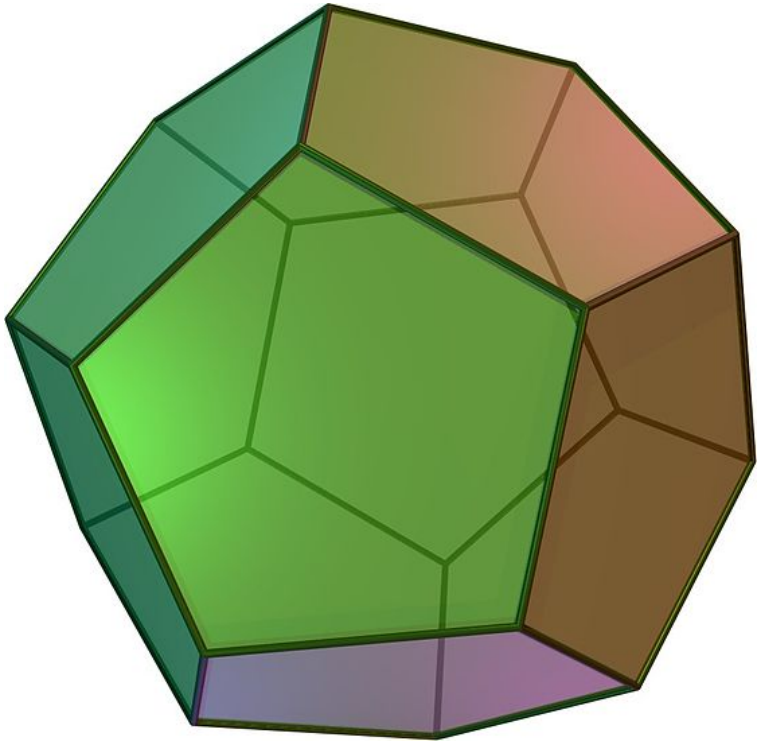
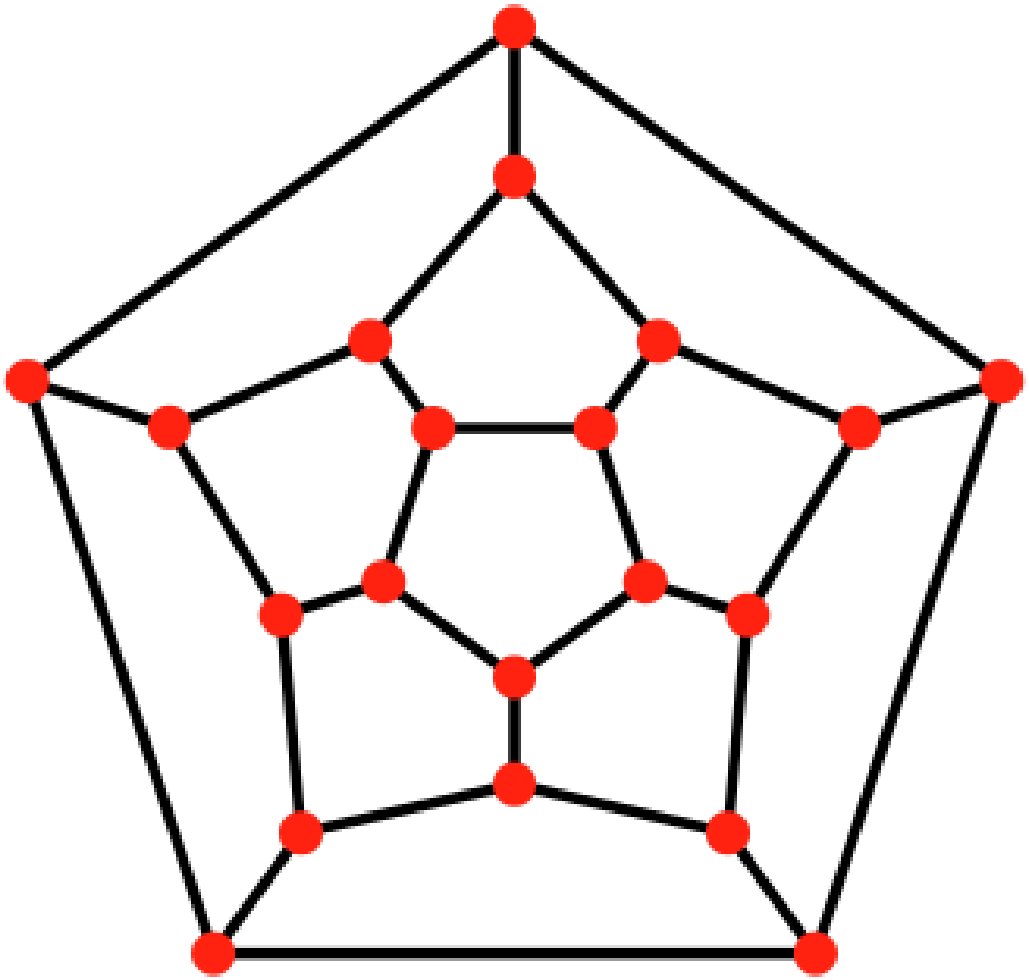


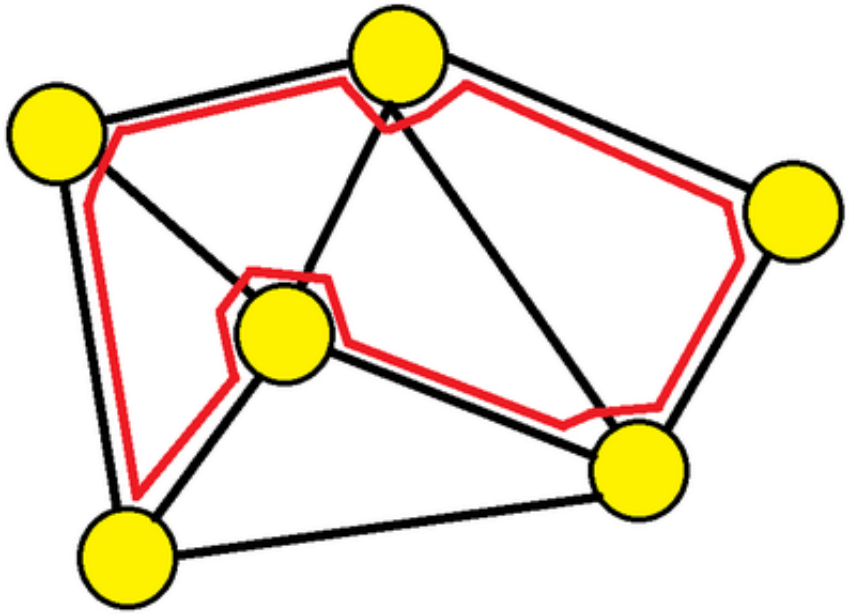
Is there a cycle that visits each *vertex* exactly once?



Is there a cycle that visits each *vertex* exactly once?

Definition (Hamiltonian Path)

A Hamiltonian path is a path that visits each vertex exactly once.



Definition (Hamiltonian Cycle)

A Hamiltonian cycle is a Hamiltonian path that is a cycle.

Definition (Hamiltonian Graph)

A graph is a Hamiltonian graph if it has a Hamiltonian cycle.

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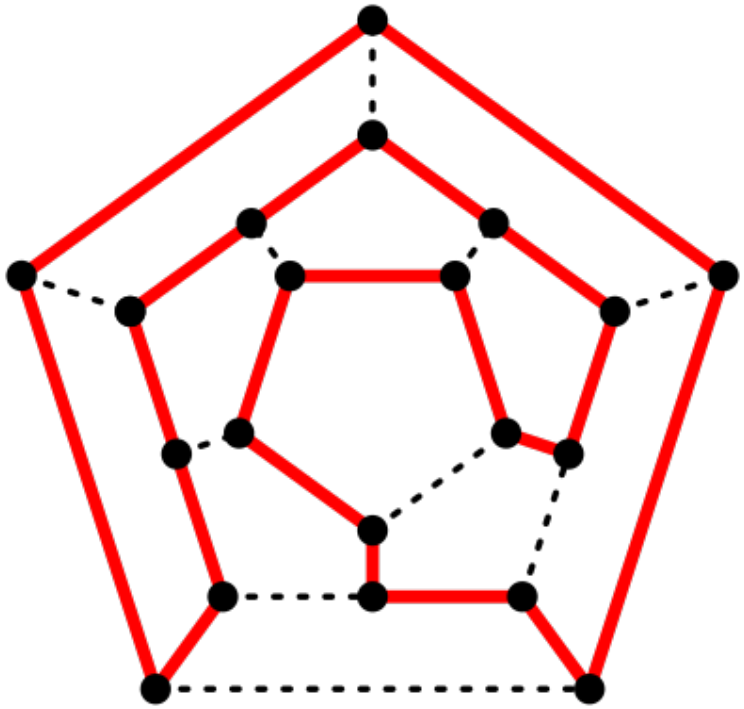
Definition (Semi-Hamiltonian Graph)

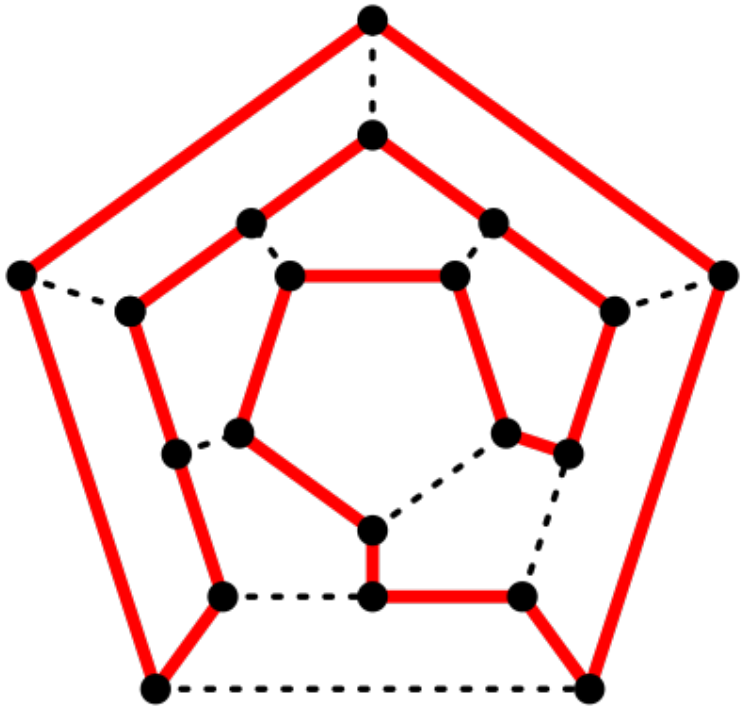
A non-Hamiltonian graph is semi-Hamiltonian if it has a Hamiltonian path.

William Rowan Hamilton
(1805 ~ 1865)

(October 16, 1843)

$$i^2 = j^2 = k^2 = ijk = -1$$





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I wish I am wrong.

Theorem

The Hamiltonian Path/Cycle problem is NP-complete.

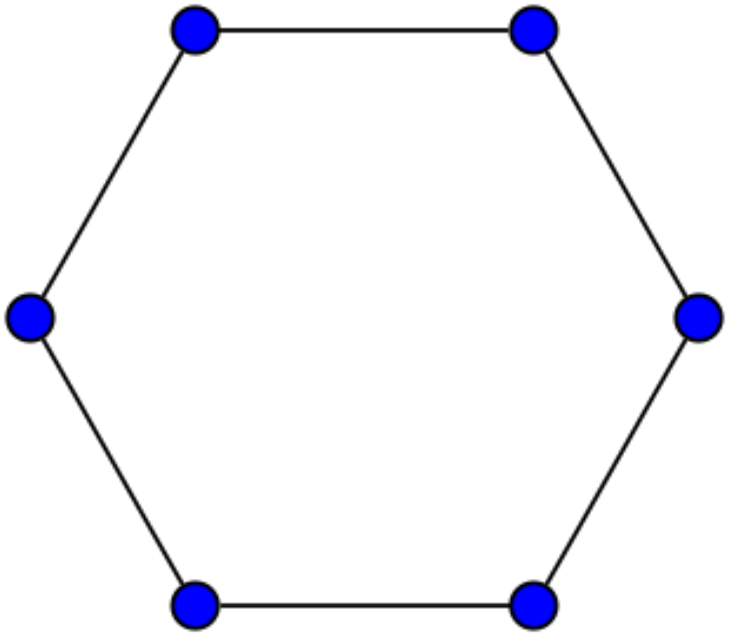
Typical (Positive/Negative) Graph Examples

Sufficient Conditions

Necessary Conditions

EXAMPLES

- Every cycle is Hamiltonian



C_6

- A complete graph (完全图) with $|V| > 2$ is Hamiltonian.

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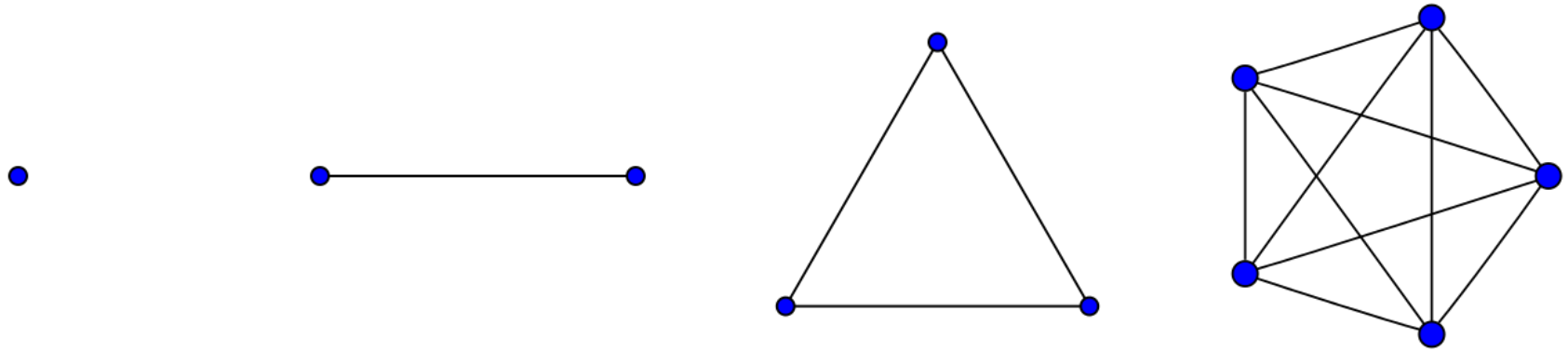
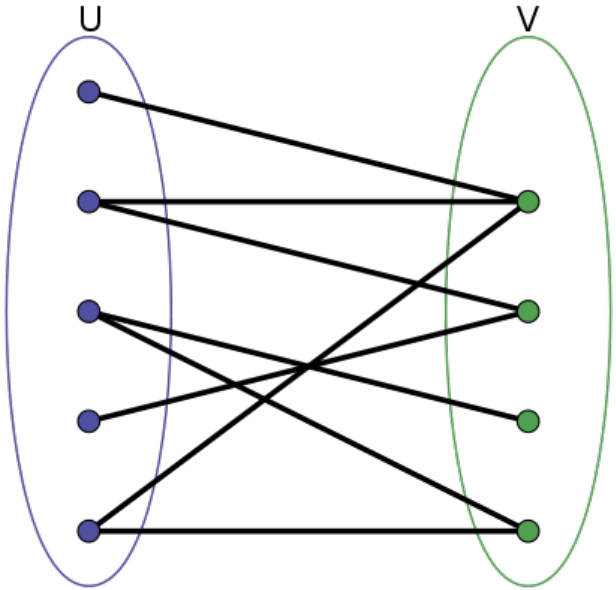


K_1 K_2 K_3 K_5

- A complete bipartite graph $K_{m,n}$ is Hamiltonian iff $m = n \geq 2$.

Definition (Bipartite Graph (Bigraph; 二部图))

A bipartite graph $G = (U, V, E)$ is a graph whose vertices can be divided into two disjoint sets U and V such that every edge connects a vertex in U to one in V.



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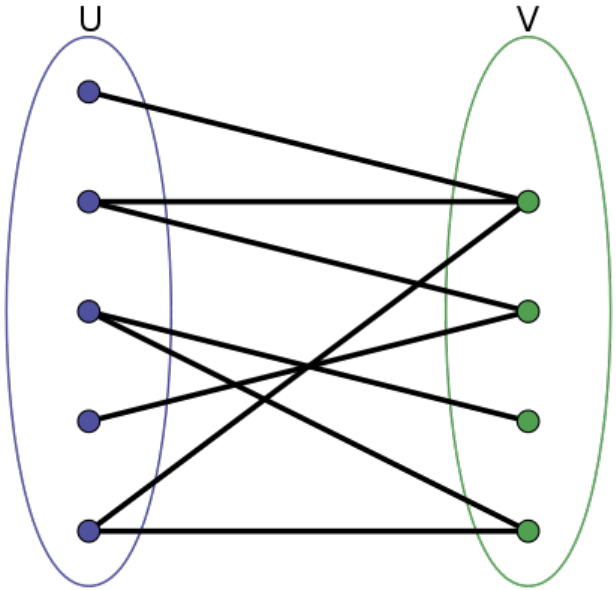

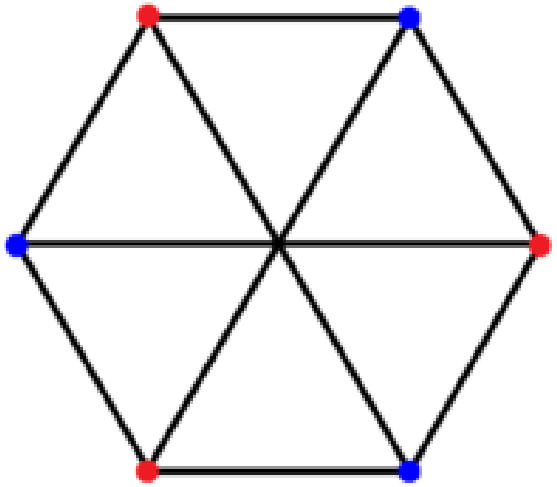

Definition (Complete Bipartite Graph (Biclique; 完全二部图))

A complete bipartite graph $G = (U, V, E)$ is bipartite graph where every vertex of U is connected to every vertex of V.

$$K_{m,n} : m = |U|, n = |V|$$

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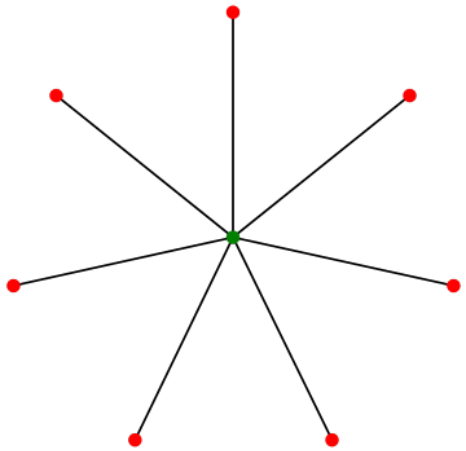
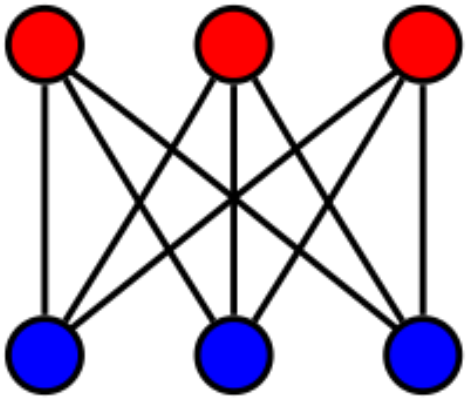
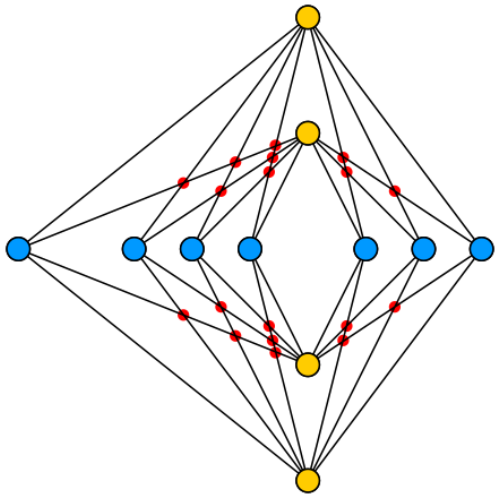


$K_{1,7}$ (star)



$K_{3,3}$ (utility graph)



$K_{4,7}$

- A complete bipartite graph $K_{m,n}$ is Hamiltonian iff $m = n \geq 2$.

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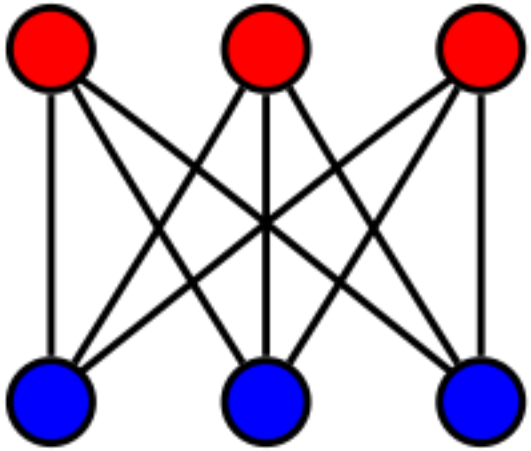

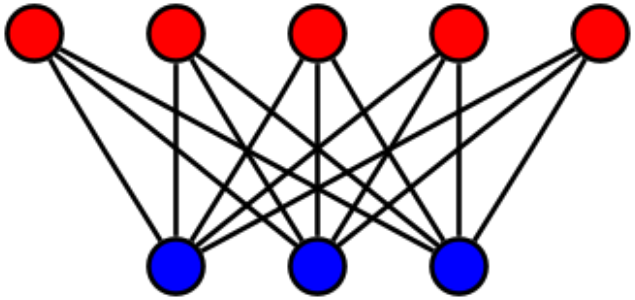

- Every platonic solid (正多面体), considered as a graph, is Hamiltonian.

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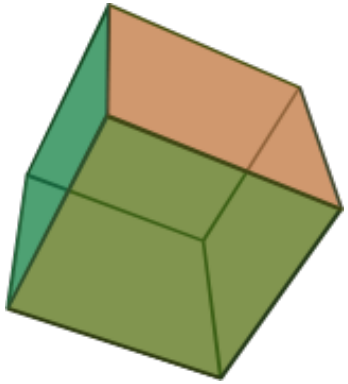
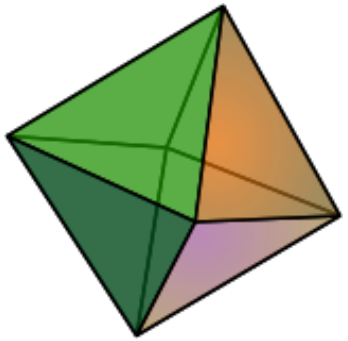
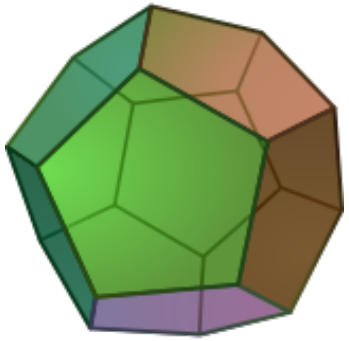
Tetrahedron



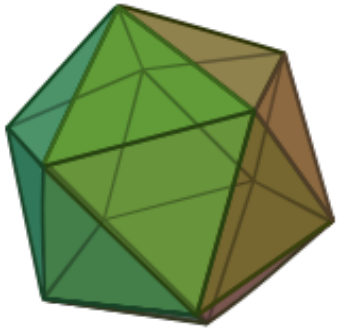
Cube



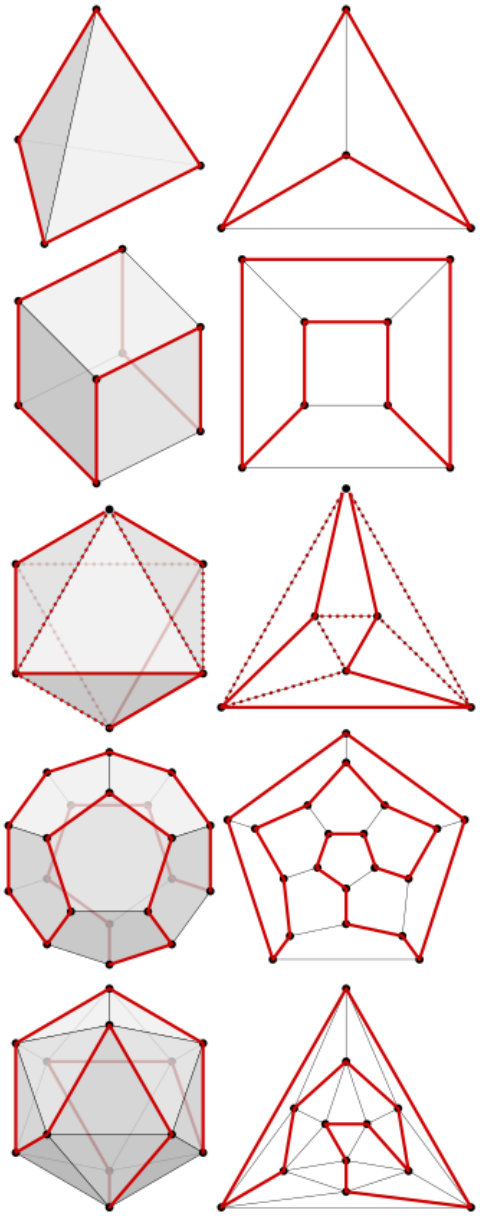
Octahedron



Dodecahedron



Icosahedron



Theorem

- *Petersen graph is not Hamiltonian.*

Julius Petersen (1839 ~ 1910)

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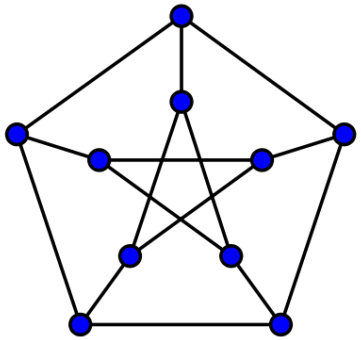

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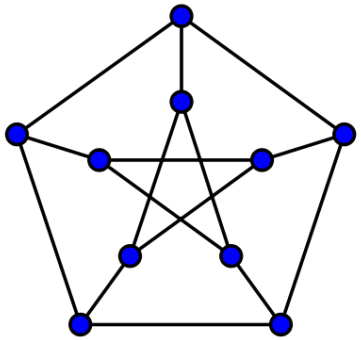

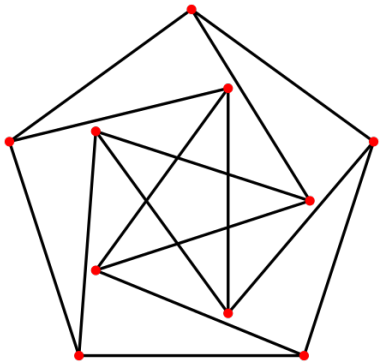

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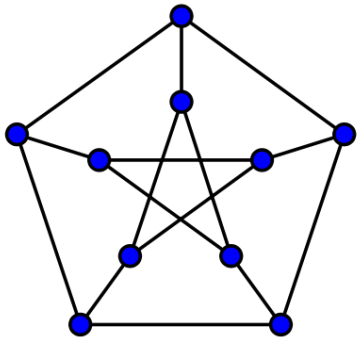

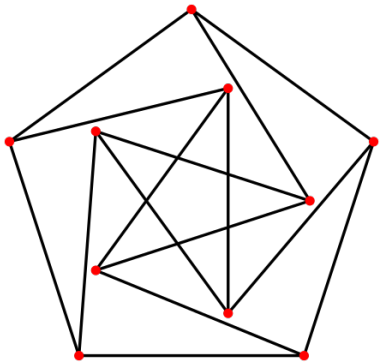

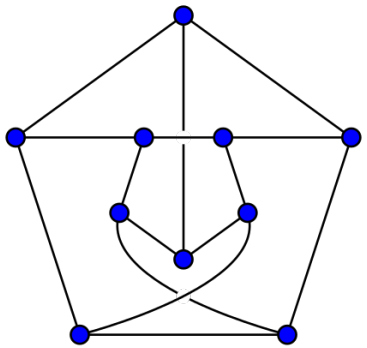

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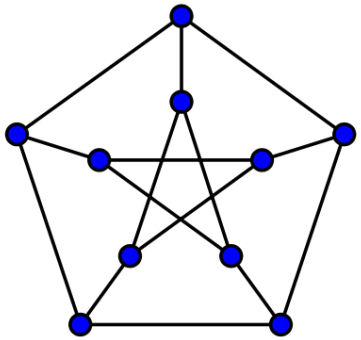

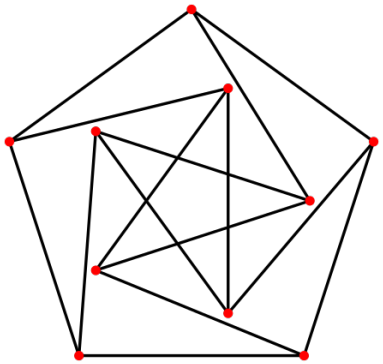

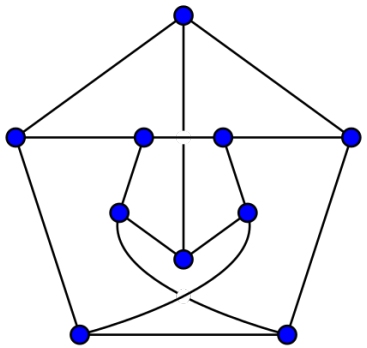

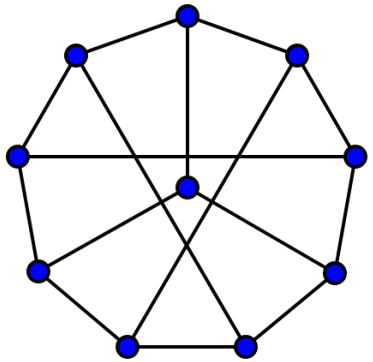

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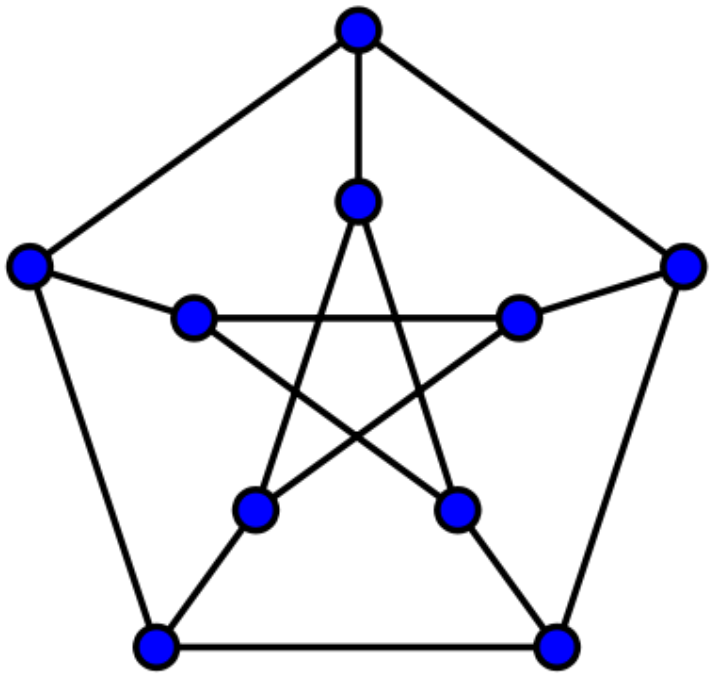

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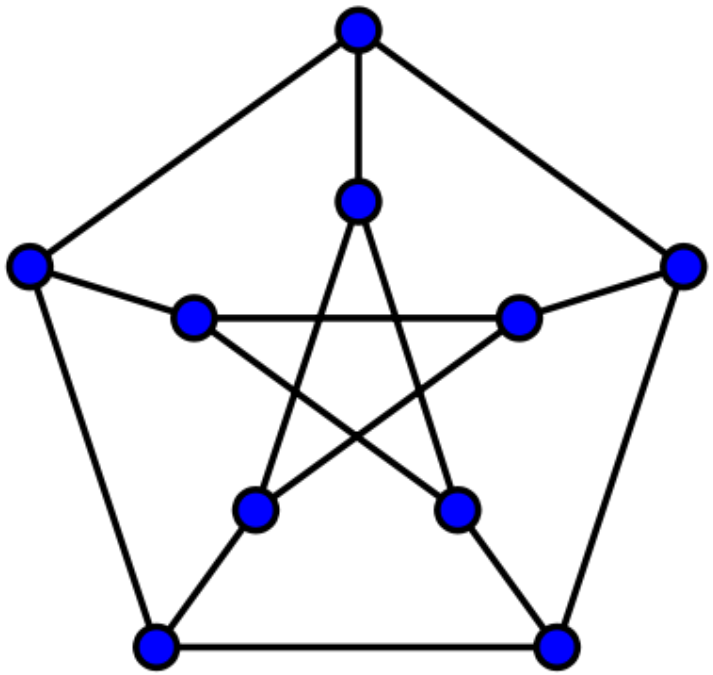

$$\forall v \in V \;\; \deg(v) = 3 \qquad \text{3-regular graph}$$

The Petersen graph has *no* cycles of length < 5.

By Contradiction.

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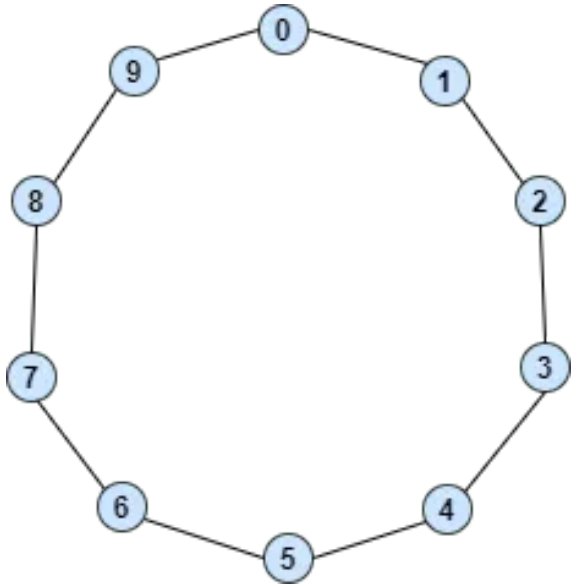
Suppose that it has a Hamiltonian cycle C.



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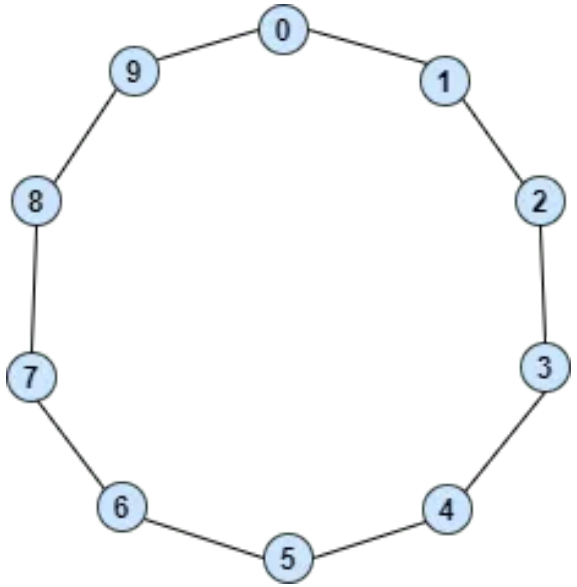
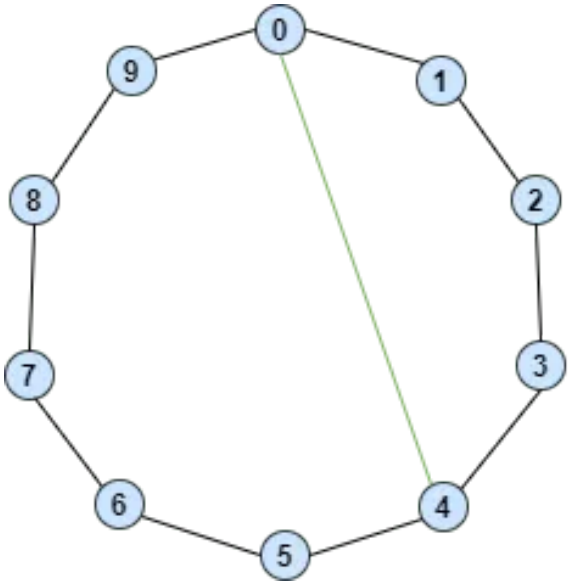


v_0 is adjacent to v_4, v_5, or v_6.

Case I: v_0 is adjacent to v_4



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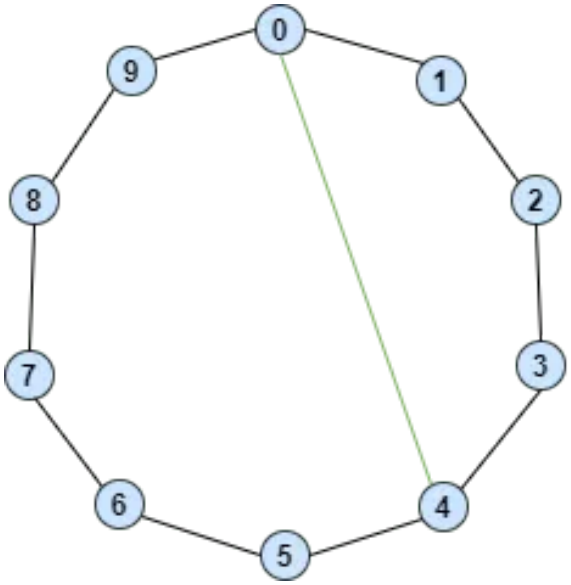

v_5 is adjacent to v_1 or v_9

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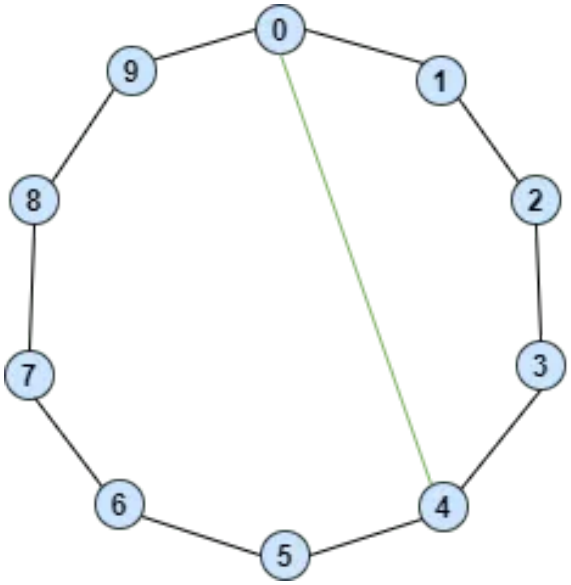

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cycle of length 4!

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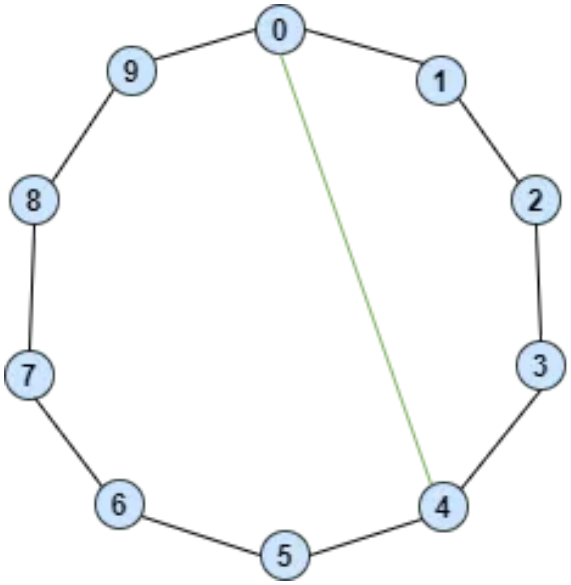

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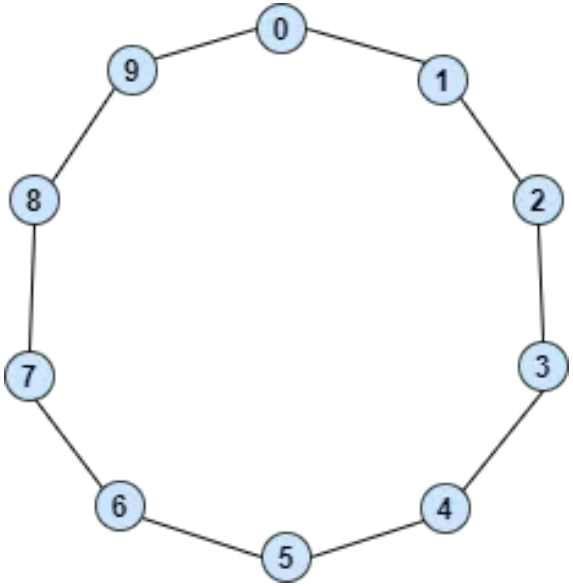
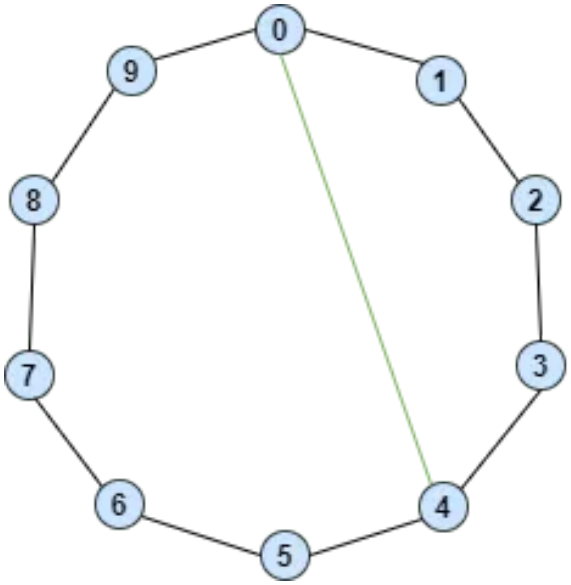


CASE I: v_0 is adjacent to v_4



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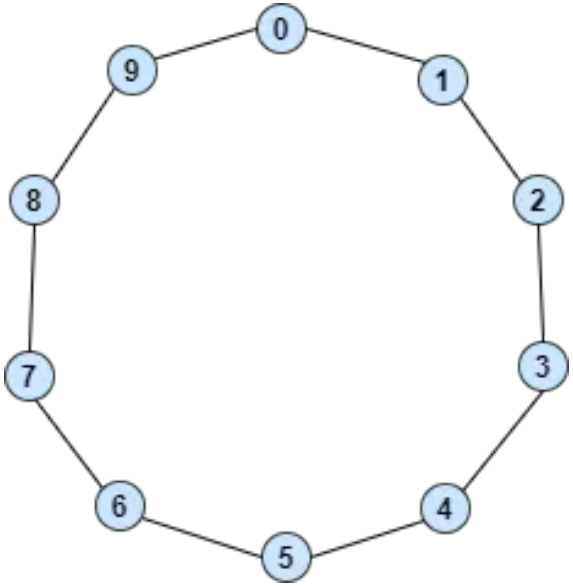

v_1 is adjacent to v_7

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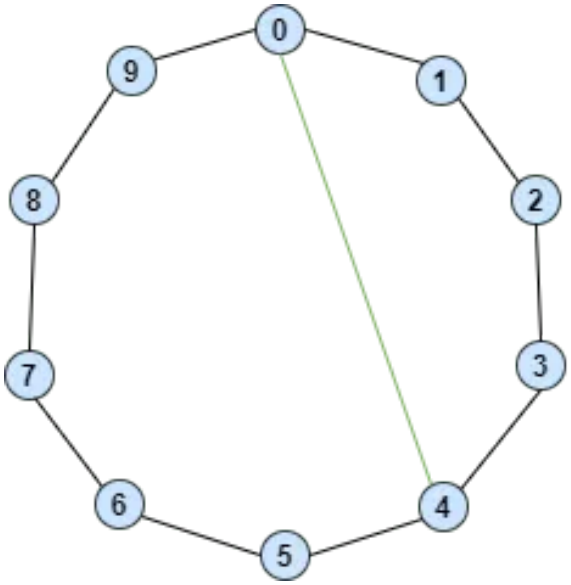

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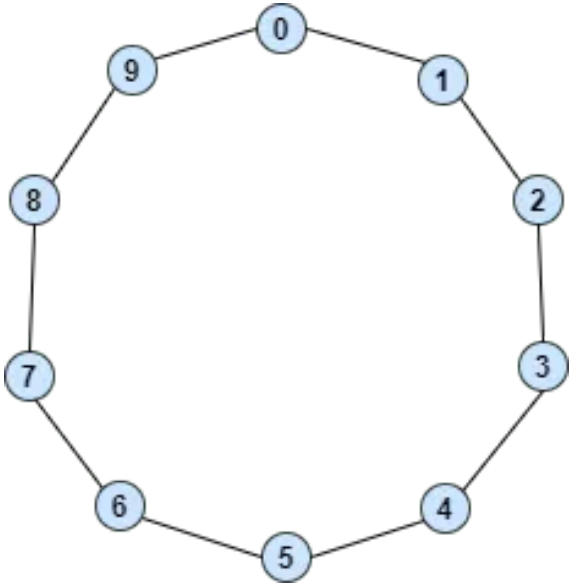

v_1 is adjacent to v_7

back to CASE I!

"If G has enough edges, then G is Hamiltonian."

Theorem (Ore's Theorem, 1960)

Let G be a simple graph with $n \geq 3$ vertices. If

$$deg(u) + deg(v) \geq n$$

for each pair of non-adjacent vertices u and v, then G is Hamiltonian.

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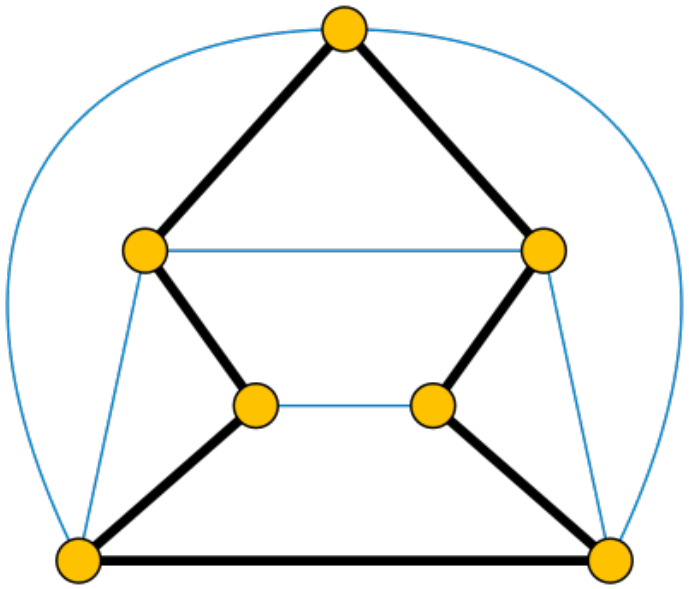

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By Extremality.

Adding edges cannot violate the Ore's Condition.

Thus we may consider only *maximal* non-Hamiltonian graphs:

adding any edge gives a Hamiltonian graph.

By its "maximality", G contains a Hamiltonian path

(G is a semi-Hamiltonian graph)

$$v_1 \to v_2 \to \cdots \to v_n$$

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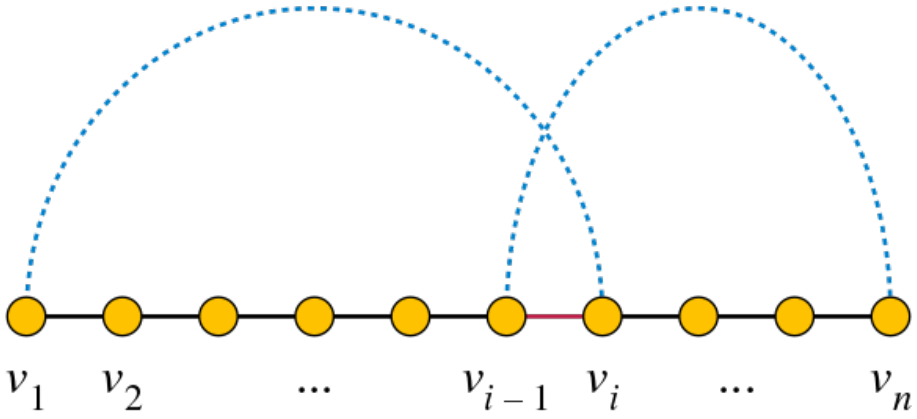

There must be some vertex v_i adjacent to v_1

such that v_{i-1} is adjacent to v_n.

Theorem (Dirac's Theorem (1952; Gabriel Andrew Dirac))

A simple graph $G = (V, E)$ with $n \geq 3$ vertices is Hamiltonian

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Family [edit | edit source]

He was born Balázs Gábor in Budapest, to Richárd Balázs, a military officer and businessman, and Margit "Manci" Wigner (sister of Eugene Wigner).[5] When his mother married Paul Dirac in 1937, he and his sister resettled in England and were formally adopted, changing their family name to Dirac.[6]

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$$\delta(G) = \lfloor (n-1)/2 \rfloor$$

Counterexample: $K_{\lfloor (n+1)/2 \rfloor}$ and $K_{\lceil (n+1)/2 \rceil}$ sharing a vertex

"If G is Hamiltonian, then G must be somewhat connected."

"If G is Hamiltonian, then G must be somewhat connected."

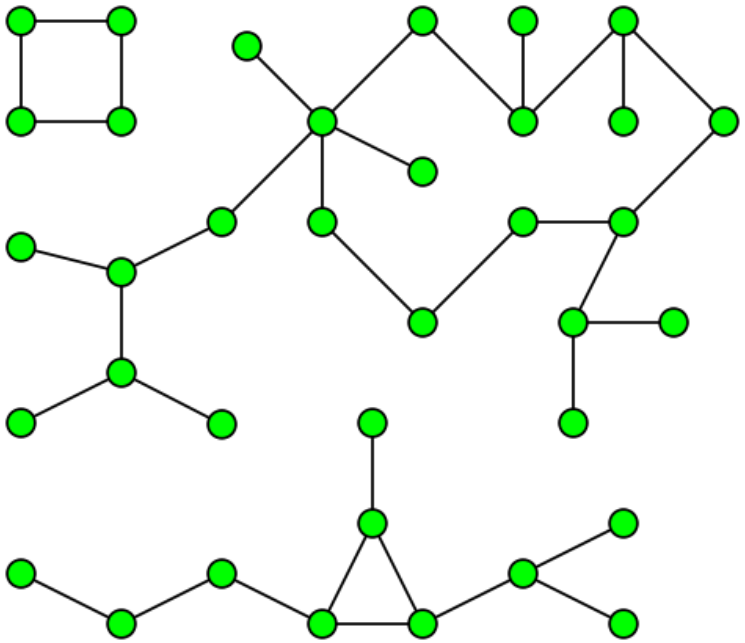
"If G is not so connected, then G is non-Hamiltonian."

Theorem

If $G = (V, E)$ is Hamiltonian, then for each nonempty set $S \subset V$, the graph $G - S$ has $\leq |S|$ components.

Definition (Components (连通分支))

A component of an undirected graph is an subgraph in which any two vertices are connected to each other by paths, and which is connected to no additional vertices in the rest of the graph.



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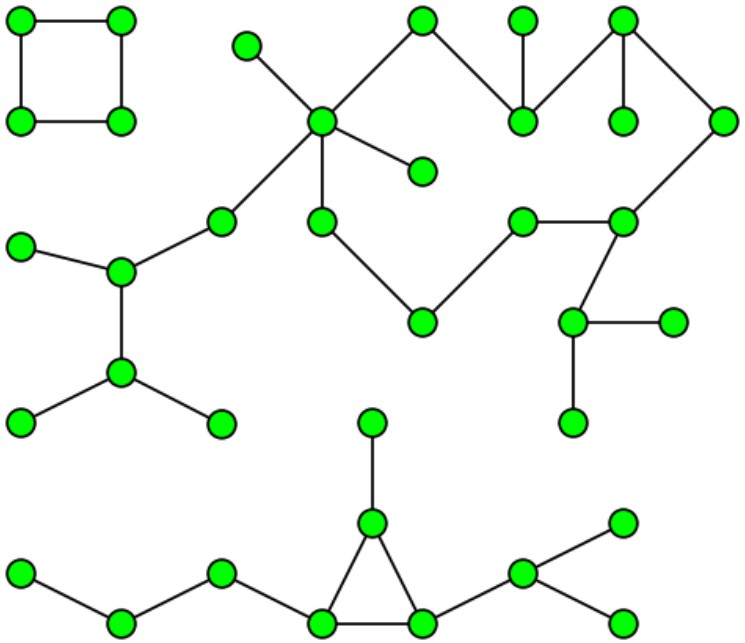

$$c(G) = 3$$

Theorem

If $G = (V, E)$ is Hamiltonian, then

$$\forall S \subset V.\ c(G - S) \leq |S|.$$

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$$S \neq V$$

Theorem

If $G = (V, E)$ is Hamiltonian, then

$$\forall S \subset V.\ c(G - S) \leq |S|.$$

$$S \neq V$$

$$K_{\lfloor (n+1)/2 \rfloor} \text{ and } K_{\lceil (n+1)/2 \rceil} \text{ sharing a vertex}$$

- A complete bipartite graph $K_{m,n}$ is Hamiltonian iff $m = n \geq 2$.

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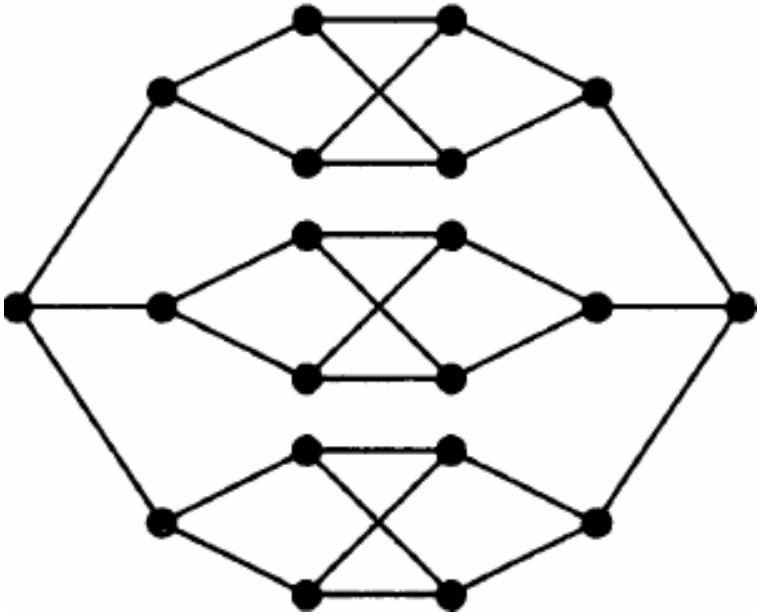

A non-Hamiltonian bipartite graph with $m = n = 10$

Theorem

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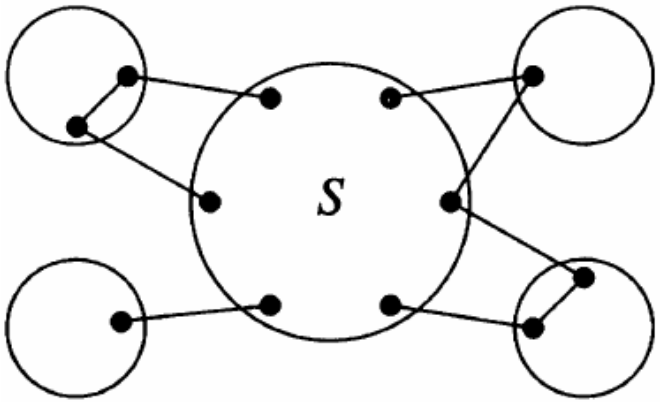

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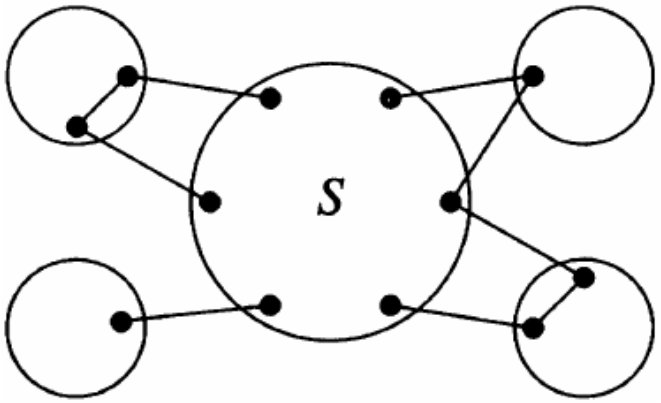

"When a Hamiltonian cycle leaves a component of $G - S$, it can go only to a distinct vertex in S."

Theorem

If $G = (V, E)$ *is Hamiltonian,*

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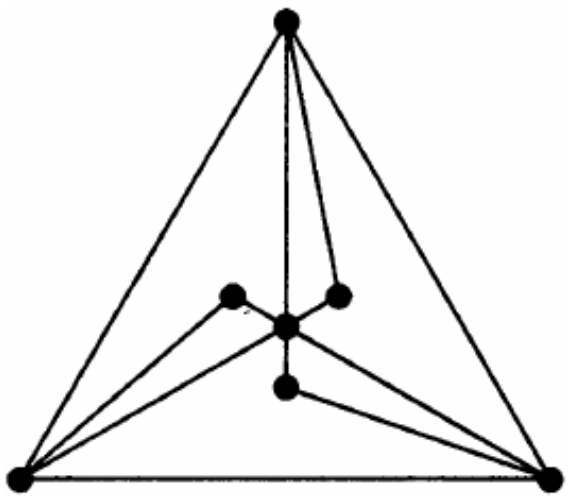

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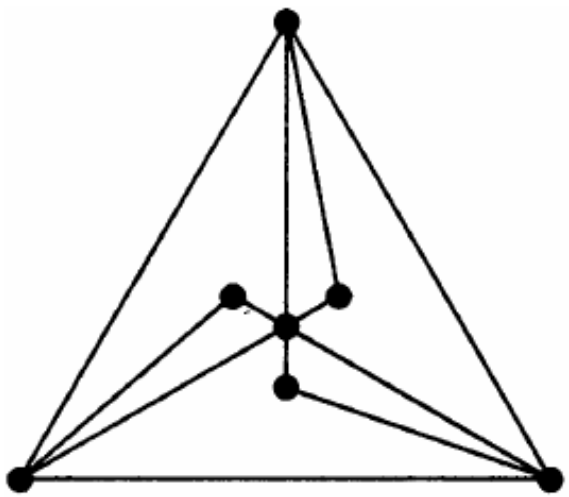
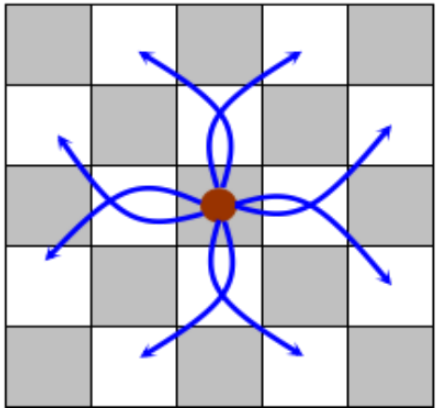
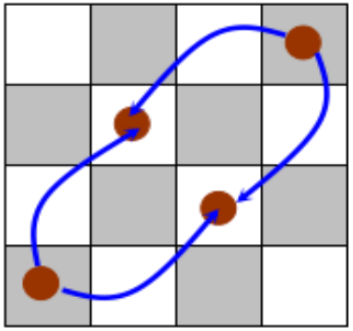


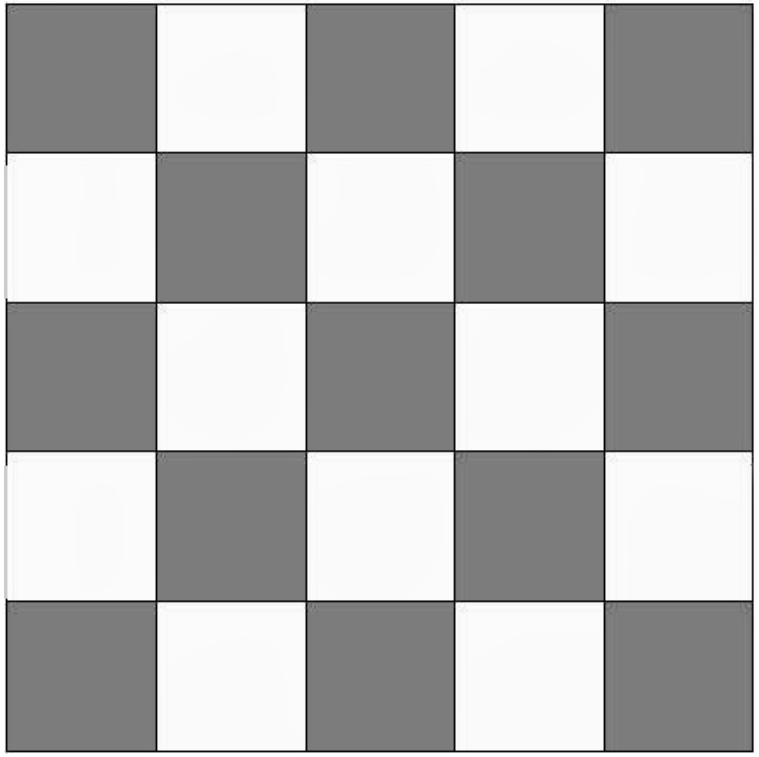
All edges incident to vertices of degree 2 must be used.

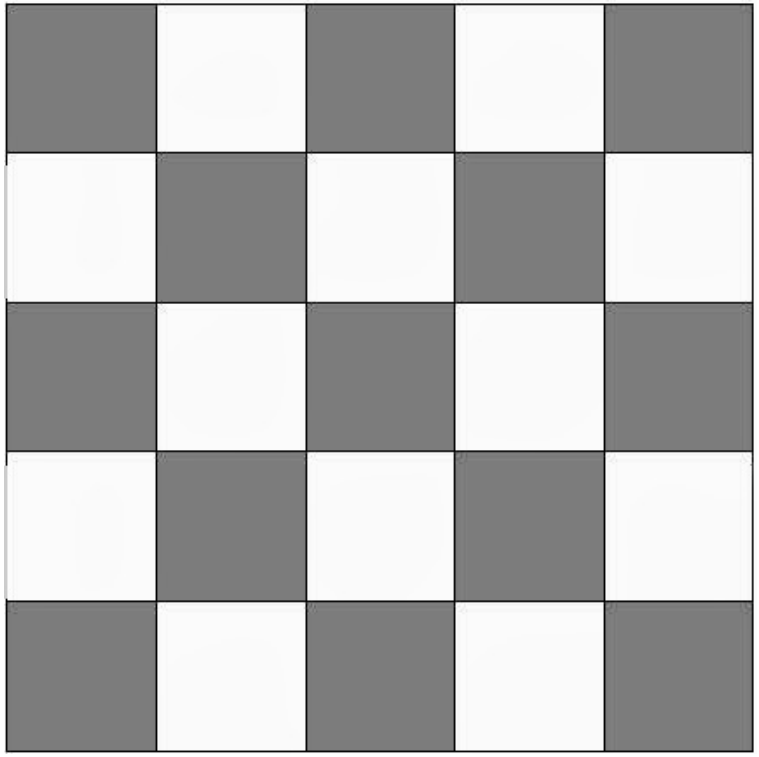
Chessboard Problem ("马踏棋盘" 问题)

Is it possible for a "knight" to visit every field of a 4×4 or 5×5 chessboard exactly once and return to the starting point?





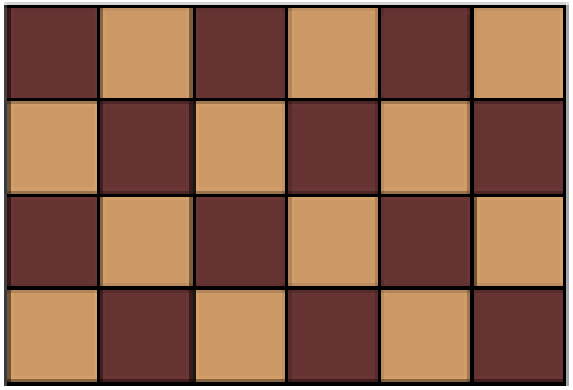


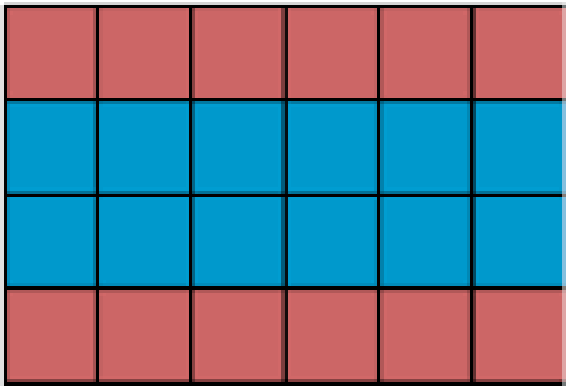


$$G = (U, V, E) : |U| = 12, |V| = 13$$

Removing the middle 4 squares leaves ≥ 5 components.

Chessboard Problem

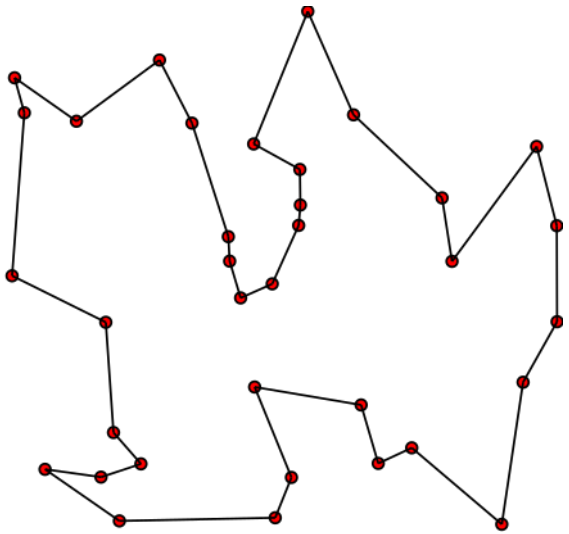


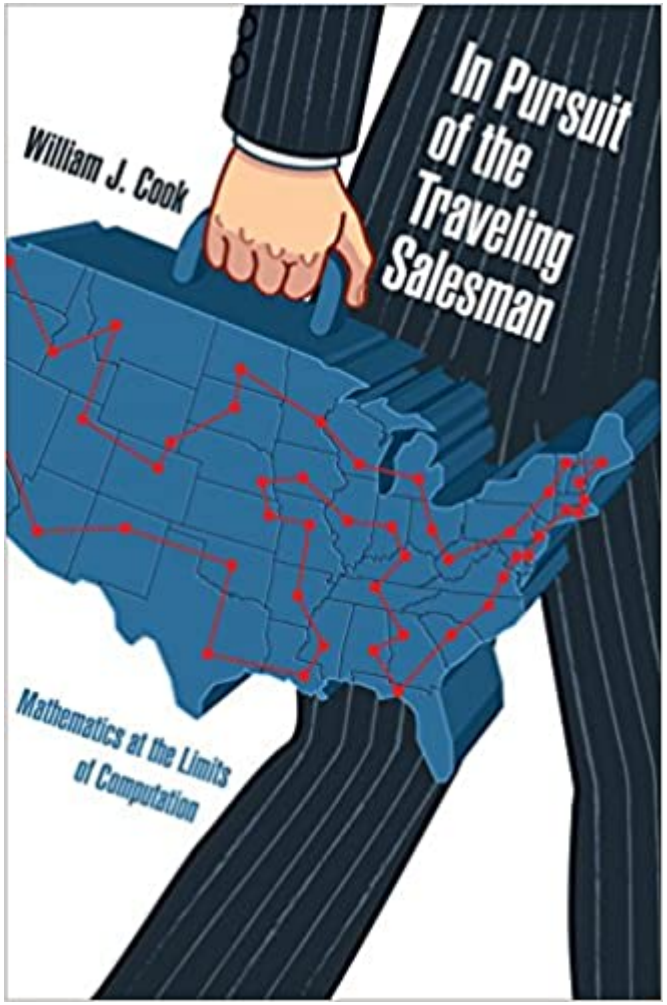


$4 \times n$

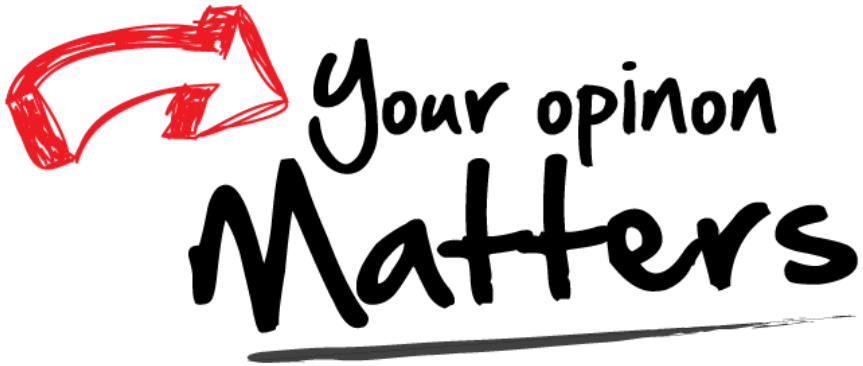
Definition (Travelling Salesman/Salesperson Problem (TSP; 旅行商问题))

Given a list of cities and the distances between each pair of cities, what is the shortest possible route that visits each city exactly once and returns to the origin city?




William J. Cook
In Pursuit of the Traveling Salesman
Mathematics at the Limits of Computation

Thank You!



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